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Notes Corresponding To Audio

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In the following pages you will find "Big Ideas" and Notes organized in approximately the order in which these concepts occur in the dialogue between Lee Milteer and myself, in the audio recordings. Most of the notes are selected, edited segments from the transcript of the audio.

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You Can.

I had a client here a couple of weeks ago, and he expressed literal envy. He said, "Gee, I sure wish I could operate my business life like you do, and get everybody to come to me, and go all day long without interruption by phone or fax or in person." He was astounded. He was here for the entire day and we were not interrupted once. And he said, 'I just *wish* I could do that."

You Don't Have To.

Everybody thinks that in *their* business they have to be immediately and constantly accessible.

But, in industry after industry, profession after profession, where that belief is religion, there's at least one – in most cases, many – person who, although initially skeptical, has adopted the same practices I use, and become more successful, not less, as a result. In each of these cases, the majority of the people in these fields would still insist they could not possibly use my methods.

Here is my contention about this, and about life in general: if there is somebody who's doing what you want to do the way you'd like to do it, then so can you. Even if there's only one, then you can be the second. That's the Roger Bannister story, of running the mile at a speed everybody said no one could run a mile in. He broke a long-standing record. But almost as soon as he broke it, another guy did, then many people did. When Ted Turner started a 24 hour news network, everybody in broadcasting predicted its failure. When it started to succeed, most then said there was only room for one. But now there's three. See, most people look at the one guy doing it and think "well, he can do it but I can't." You have to look at that guy and think "if he can, so can I." It is a way of looking at life. It incorporates self-image.

So, you do NOT have to do anything the way it's typically done or others think it has to be done or you've always thought it needs to be done or is supposed to be done. Forget all that. Start with what you want to do.

Decision.

It all starts with the decisions you make about how you're going to do business and how people are going to do business with you. Two things: how are you going to do business? How are others going to do business with you?

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Bye.

Everybody, no matter how good a job they do, loses some customers or clients every year. For all sorts of reasons. The customer moves away, die, stops using the product or service, switches to a friend who gets into the business. You lose customers all the time. You obviously figure out how to replace them. So what's the big deal about replacing a few more you lose because of the way you choose to do business?

What Can't Be Replaced.

Customers: replaceable. Money: replaceable. The ONLY thing you *can't* replace is the minute you just used up reading this. Or any other minute used. It's gone. Gone forever. Can NOT be replaced or replenished. So it just seems obvious to me that your top priority must be protecting the only asset you have that can't be replaced.

Most people give more thought to protecting the crap stored in their garage than to protecting their time!

I Can't Afford To Take This Approach Now. Yet.

Then it'll be never.

Pretty much everything I do now, I was doing long before anybody would think I could financially afford to do it. There's never a perfect time to start. There's always a reason to wait.

Actually, most of the time and productivity methods that I use actually increase the desire of the marketplace, peoples' eagerness to do business with you.

Truth is, you can't afford to wait.

Brain Fog.

We've arrived at a point of constant, unrelenting communication. This puts so much more pressure on people, that have dire consequences. All the recovery time is gone. It's causing 'brain overload.' Mistakes are being made left and right. Tempers flaring. Opportunities overlooked. Early, extreme burn-out. You just cannot operate in this environment of constant, unrelenting, open communication. How do you stop? Stop. Refuse to participate.

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The #1 Business Idiocy Of Our Time.

There's no virtue in thoughtless response.

Given unrestricted access, cell, e-mail, pressure for, expectation of instant response, you are reached at inopportune times, at inappropriate places, with no advance notice, no time to think. So now, you're rushing through your conversations. You agree to things you shouldn't, and wouldn't if you gave the matter appropriate thought. Tempermental responses occur. Nerves frayed, and the other person hears it. This is not productive. Instant or quick is not the same as productive. Instant, anytime access is certainly not the same as effective.

Are You E-Mail Obsessed?

In an office, you used to be able to spot the fatheads, the really useless executives and salespeople. When the mailman arrived, they stopped whatever they were doing and rushed up to the front desk to check the mail. Sort of like factory workers' Pavlovian response to the honking horn of the food truck, the 'roach coach' pulling into the parking lot. Now you can see the fools all around you. They are e-mail obsessed. They check it 12 times a day. That's why Starbucks and car dealership waiting rooms have internet access, so everybody can check their e-mail. Now you can do it with your cellphone. This is the equivalent of having the mailman come to the office ten times a day rather than once, bringing just one letter each time, and everybody rushing out of their offices ten times a day to see what he's brought. Grow up, for heaven's sake. **Try to find something important enough to do that you're unwilling to be so easily and frequently interrupted and distracted.** You'll make a lot more money doing that, than checking e-mail every hour.

Psychological Triggers

Think of the subconscious as an extremely competent but poorly motivated, easily distracted employee.

It's been proven that in factories, safety posters reduce accidents. These are Psychological Triggers. They remind people to lift properly. Not to stick their head into the oven. Similarly, you need visual and environmental devices to remind your subconscious of what it's supposed to be doing, to motivate, to keep it interested and engaged. Or it dozes off.

The Pictures In Your Mind Are Magnetic.

I sit with clients, usually early in a day of consulting, when they are eager to dive into the nitty-gritty mechanics of what they're doing, and I back them up and ask "Tell me what you want your business TO LOOK LIKE in 3, 4,5 years. What you want your business life to look like."

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This forces you to think differently. When I ask you 'what do you want your business to look like in 3 years?', your mind does something differently than if I ask 'tell me what you want your sales to be in 3 years'.

The subconscious mind works with pictures. If you create your targets in visual terms, as pictures, not just written words or language, and certainly not just numbers, you get much better, faster results. In fact, if you really implant clear pictures, you can't help but wind up living them. (So this is dangerous, too.)

As Incredible As It May Seem....

Most people get up in the morning and go to work with little if any preconceived idea of what is going to be accomplished that day.

You Can't Create Real Success With Fantasy Thought.

The truthful and accurate view about getting anything done is that there are obstacles. Fools pretend there are none, like trying to ignore the proverbial elephant in the room. Problem is, when you open your eyes, the damned elephant's still there, and he's taken a big, steaming dump, too.

The reason we're in the mess we're in, in Iraq? Rumsfeld's list he says he turned in before the war of the fifteen really bad things that might happen was ignored instead of being used as a planning document. I'm always trying to foresee the problems. If I was going to take my girlfriend out for a canoe ride, which would never happen, but if I was, I'd have more than one oar. So if I let the one slip out of my grasp, we wouldn't be stuck out in the middle of the lake.

As Pogo Said...

" We have met the enemy and they is us."

Most of peoples' ineffectiveness, inefficiency, poor productivity and unsatisfactory results are rooted in being in the wrong place, in the wrong environment, to do the job at hand.

A Poor Carpenter Blames His Tools. But....

....you do need good tools. The productivity tools I find most useful are:

The Storyboard, and Displayed Thinking. There's a whole dissertation on this in the Archives, in this book.

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Lists.

A Schedule. Preferably, for the year, each month, each week, each day.

A Daily Activity Chart. This standardizes or institutionalizes the things you need to discipline yourself to do everyday. You put it up where it nags you. You check off the items.

The Conversation Planner. This is a list, one for each key person you deal with, of the stuff you need to talk about and the stuff you did talk about.

The Delegation List. Similar to The Conversation Planner. This actually keeps track of agreements. Who did you tell to do what by when. Then you check up and check off.

The FAX. It's fast, but not so easy and instant it encourages thoughtless communication.

Most people are trying to do a lot of this with memory. It doesn't work.

Somebody'll say: that's too many tools. Well, how many different tools do you want the crew building your home to have? Or the team doing your heart operation? All they need. Why? Because they're doing something important. What's more important than managing your time? Nothing.

You Can't Gain Weight From An Empty Refrigerator.

If you're fully booked, then nobody can throw off your schedule. Time can only be wasted or abused or swiped if there's time *available* to be wasted or abused or swiped.

Most To-Do Lists And Calendars Are B.S.

Here's why: the items have start times but no end times.

All my appointments, all my phone appointments, and all my tasks have pre-determined end times. If there's no end time, it's not an appointment. A flight has a take-off time and an arrival time. I ain't getting on board if the arrival time is: whenever.

If you just make this change, you change your entire life.

Time Management Is Linked To Integrity.

If you have integrity, you take your every commitment seriously. Most people do not take their commitments seriously. This tells you what to expect from them.

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What Are Your Daily Disciplines?

Stephen Cannell (Rockford Files, A-Team) says he writes everyday. He says he no longer needs to write for money. But he writes everyday. Seven days a week. His wife thinks he's compulsive. But whatever you don't do regularly, by routine, by commitment, has a way of not getting done at all.

What Others Think (About Phone Appointments)

Working as I do only with pre-scheduled phone appointments is efficient AND effective AND win-win. It benefits everybody else as much as it does me. It eliminates phone tag. The other person has my complete attention. I can be effective because I am in an appropriate place, I've prepared.

It's your responsibility to sell others on doing business with you on *your* terms, for *their* benefit.

Look, you can sell people on *any* terms. To be in the Catholic religion, you once had to agree only to eat fish sticks on Friday, no birth control, confession, give money, etc. I'm not picking on Catholicism – but as example, seriously, if you can hand people their set of rules for doing business with them and sell that, you can sell people on any set of rules. EST put people in seminars where they couldn't go out of the room to go to the bathroom. In one business, we made people swear in writing they and their spouse had listened to 16 hours of tapes before they could buy anything. Marriage: for richer OR POORER, 'til DEATH. People actually bought *that* !

Feel Pity For Them.

I'm both amused and feel pity for the people at seminars who, on every break, have to rush out to be on their cellphones. They can't network. They can't pee. They MUST phone. Sad. Humiliating. Pathetic. They can't stow their luggage on the airline without simultaneously talking on the phone. They can't eat lunch. They can't go to their kid's ballgame. They can't go an hour. I can go days. Pity the fools.

Good News, Bad News.

Good news: you're your own boss. Bad news: you're your own boss.

The only accountability that really exists for the entrepreneur is reaching or missing targets. There are (only) money targets and time targets.

Most are trying to manage only with the money targets. But it's the time use targets that make it possible to hit or miss the money targets. Time targets reached or missed are predictive indicators, money targets hit or missed are trailing indicators.

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A lot of business owners even pay fat salaries to their bean-counters. They have a CFO, a Chief Financial Officer. They need a CTO, Chief Time Officer.

From The Renegade Millionaire System:

Success is ultimately and fundamentally about behavior.

Not attitude, not upbringing, not education, not skill, not luck, not capital. It is about behavior.

If a person behaves in a way that is incongruent with the goals he is trying to achieve, he cannot achieve them.

Wake Up And Live

That's the title of a good, classic self-improvement book by Dorthea Brande. I borrow it here. You need to wake up *to* live. You need to be exceptionally CONSCIOUS. Most people are unconscious. They do the same things the same way by rote. They don't even notice what's going on around them. Their time is consumed without any consciousness about where it's going, who's getting it. Poor people, people with no financial security, are the worst about being able to tell you where their money went. Unproductive people can't tell you where their time went. If you can't tell me where your time went yesterday, I can tell you where it went. Down the sewer.

Advanced Strategy: Scheduling vs. Scripting

My days aren't just scheduled, they are fully scripted. You don't shoot a movie with an outline. Too much is at stake. Nobody will give you money to produce a movie without a script. So, I think too much is at stake here. I use a script.

Bias For Action

People who get things done now, fast, have programmed themselves to get things done now, fast, and are usually irritated a lot when it's not going that way. Might not be heart healthy; I'm no expert. But it definitely has a lot to do with bank account health. And they take MASSIVE action. When they put something in motion, they put a lot in motion. Multiple steps simultaneously, not sequentially. I think you need to assess your own behavior. When you get your paws on something worth implementing, how likely are you to use it? **What's your idea to implementation ratio?** 1 in 10, 1 in 100, 1 in 4? Do you measure *that* ? How fast?

Advanced Strategy: Self-Discipline vs. Self-Imposed Discipline

This document is getting done today NOT because I am a man of iron-willed self-discipline. It is because I told Vicky it would be in her hands tomorrow. I work under

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self-imposed discipline; I make commitments, then I work like hell to honor them. Dr. Maltz established the failure of self-discipline. Trying to get anything done with teeth-gritted, whip your own back self-discipline, unsustainable. It is easier to implant a strong sense of honor and integrity than to implant superhuman self-discipline. Then you only need a commitment, a deadline, an assessment of time required as trigger.

The Secret Of Influence & Getting Your Own Way

If you intend to make a lot of demands on others, you can't have them saying you are full of shit behind your back. You need MORAL AUTHORITY.

Zero Tolerance Policy

You must have some things about which you have a zero tolerance policy. As a society, we've said we have a zero tolerance policy about premeditated murder. In the Christian religion, there aren't The Ten Suggestions. You cannot possibly control your business life and working relationships with others with a fuzzy, vague, gray, moving line. Everything can't be negotiable. Everything can't be situational. Everything can't be relative.

You Shouldn't Try And Do Business With Everybody.

If you can accommodate and satisfy everybody, you're a doormat. Because somebody is not a good client for you doesn't mean he's not a good person nor does it mean he's not going to be a good client for somebody else. There are several wealthy, brilliant people I respect tremendously who I wouldn't take, and have refused, as clients.

If You Panic Over An Isolated Complaint, You're A Bonehead.

I'm amazed at how quick people are to abandon their way of doing business if just one person objects. As a man, I'm embarrassed by the lack of balls in a lot of the males guilty of this.

Power Comes From Supply/Demand, Not Acquiescence.

You do not gain or secure power in the marketplace by giving into everybody, by appeasement, accommodation, acting out of fear. You get power only by having more people standing in line, eager to do business with you, than you need or want. That is a product of positioning, promotion, marketing, and other strategies.

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Extreme Control = Extreme Freedom

People look at how I script my days, control time, and think it's too restrictive, it's a sacrifice of freedom. They are wrong. I am able to do everything I want, because of the extreme measures I use.

The Secret Of 'Super Achievement'

This secret, enunciated all the way back, by Carnegie, is a controversial one. It is carefully measured arrogance. A sense of superiority, so that you deserve all the success, wealth, power you seek. And I will tell you where my sense of superiority comes from: my control of my life, compared to everyone else's lack of control.

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Big Idea

BILL GATES once hung a map of Africa in his garage so that he would have something to occupy his mind for the three seconds while he turned off the ignition of his Porsche.

(Source: Esquire, 2/03)

We hate wasting time. I've long hated standing around pumping my own gas, because instead of doing that minimum wage work, I could be sitting inside my car doing maximum wage work; listening to a useful tape, editing a manuscript. I have trained myself to work productively in small, interrupted hunks of time when necessary, so I don't waste the 'five minutes here, fifteen minutes there' common in travel, errand running, and so forth.

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Big Idea

" You are subject to your environment, therefore, select the environment that will best develop you toward your desired objective."

- W. Clement Stone

This is from my Power Points (#908). If you are not familiar with Mr. Stone, you should be. Do some homework. To the statement, I concur, and I am a champion of creating your own "success environment." I oppose trying to be productive under conditions or circumstances that are not conducive to the particular task or work you're involved in. Making an important call, having an important conversation on a cellphone in a noisy restaurant is incredibly stupid --- at least as dumb as trying to write an important book while sitting with your laptop in the center of a busy freeway, with cars whizzing by on both sides, barely avoiding running you over. Working in a space that is not organized and laid out to support your work and work style – why? Tolerating incessant interruptions – why? Place matters. Environment matters.

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Big Idea

PROCRASTINATION is not evil, as almost all time management authors and speakers portray it. Quite a few things do not deserve to be done right now. Some things resolve themselves if ignored. The "do it now" habit should not be translated to "do everything now."

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Big Idea

" There will come a time when big opportunities will be presented to you, and you've got to be in a position to take advantage of them."

Sam Walton

It's simple: to be productive when there's an opportunity to do so, you have to be prepared. Informed, mentally fit, emotionally fit, physically fit, with cash, other resources, a network of useful contacts, a book of favors that can be called in, honed and polished skills. At the very same time you are doing whatever you are doing now, you have to be preparing for hoped for and unknown opportunities to come.

Let me give you a simple example. One of my book publishers sent me two clippings, one from a trade journal, the other from a newspaper, both favorably mentioning my No B.S. books published in 2004. They pay a clipping service to monitor publications for such things. Neither clipping had enough contact information to communicate with the writers. My publisher thinks nothing of that. They view this as a "conclusion", a positive thing to celebrate and report. I view it as the start of something, to carefully cultivate for the future. I will track these writers down, send them a thank you note, books, a bobblehead and invite visit to my web sites. I will send them my newsletter every month. I will put them "in the bank" for the next time I have a book to publicize. I am always preparing for the next opportunities.

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Big Idea

"There will come a time in your life when you will clearly have the opportunity to accomplish more in 12 months than in the previous 12 years."

- Earl Nightingale

I call this 'THE PHENOMENON." It seems to occur for entrepreneurs who are doing a lot, promoting a lot, innovating, putting themselves out there, one to several times in their lives. Very recently, we all saw an example with Donald Trump, and what he's been able to do with and because of 'The Apprentice.' I have had THE PHENNOMENON three different times in my life, and a fourth is occurring right now. You have to be alert for this and capitalize on it fully and aggressively when it does occur.

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Mistakes Entrepreneurs Make With Their Time

(That Renegade Millionaires Do Not)

Permit others to dictate agenda, schedule, way you work

Each RM that I know has developed and adheres to a way of working that is productive for them. Some are neat freaks and have a full-time assistant doing nothing but filing, others (like me) operate in controlled clutter, with project piles. Some dictate, some use laptops, some still use legal pads. Some go to their office on a regular schedule, others at random, others not at all. The key issue is not being handed a set of "time management techniques" and forcing yourself to use them, but to find time management techniques that work for you. When you land on one, you refuse to be dislodged from it. Everyone else must adjust or be gone.

Tolerate 'Time Vampires', others' waste of their time

RM's have very low tolerance for those who habitually waste time and disrupt productivity. I suggest 'three strikes and you're out'. Employee, vendor, even client: explain why their behavior is incompatible with the way you work and/or interfering with your productivity and describe the substitute behavior desired. Sit the Vampire down for that talk three times. Say: "Strike One. Strike Two. Strike Three – and you're out. Next."

If you have Vampires sucking your blood now, make the list. Plan The Talk to have with them on a 3x5" card with their name on it. Go play baseball.

Permit commoditization of themselves, services, so they are weak, vulnerable and

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fearful in relationships with clients or customers

This is a fundamental power issue. If you are or feel commoditized, hustle and fix it. Re-invent, alter your marketing, work like a fiend to put (perception of) supply vs. demand, specialist vs. generalist to work for you rather than against you. RM's do NOT operate from fear. That is not really because they are fearless, but because they've created a set of circumstances for themselves that makes it easy to be fearless.

Operate without targets

RM's use a lot of benchmarks, numbers, statistics, goals, to hold themselves and others accountable, daily, weekly, monthly, yearly, per project, per function.

Work in unproductive environments

RM's are able to produce good results under adverse conditions – but strive not to be in that position very often. Whether at home, in their place of business, traveling, wherever, whatever, they exert control over their environment, and give themselves every advantage to support productivity.

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Tab #1

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Articles from 'It's About Time'

The following pages are a complete reprint of a book first published in 1994, co-authored with Bill Brooks.

IT'S ABOUT TIME

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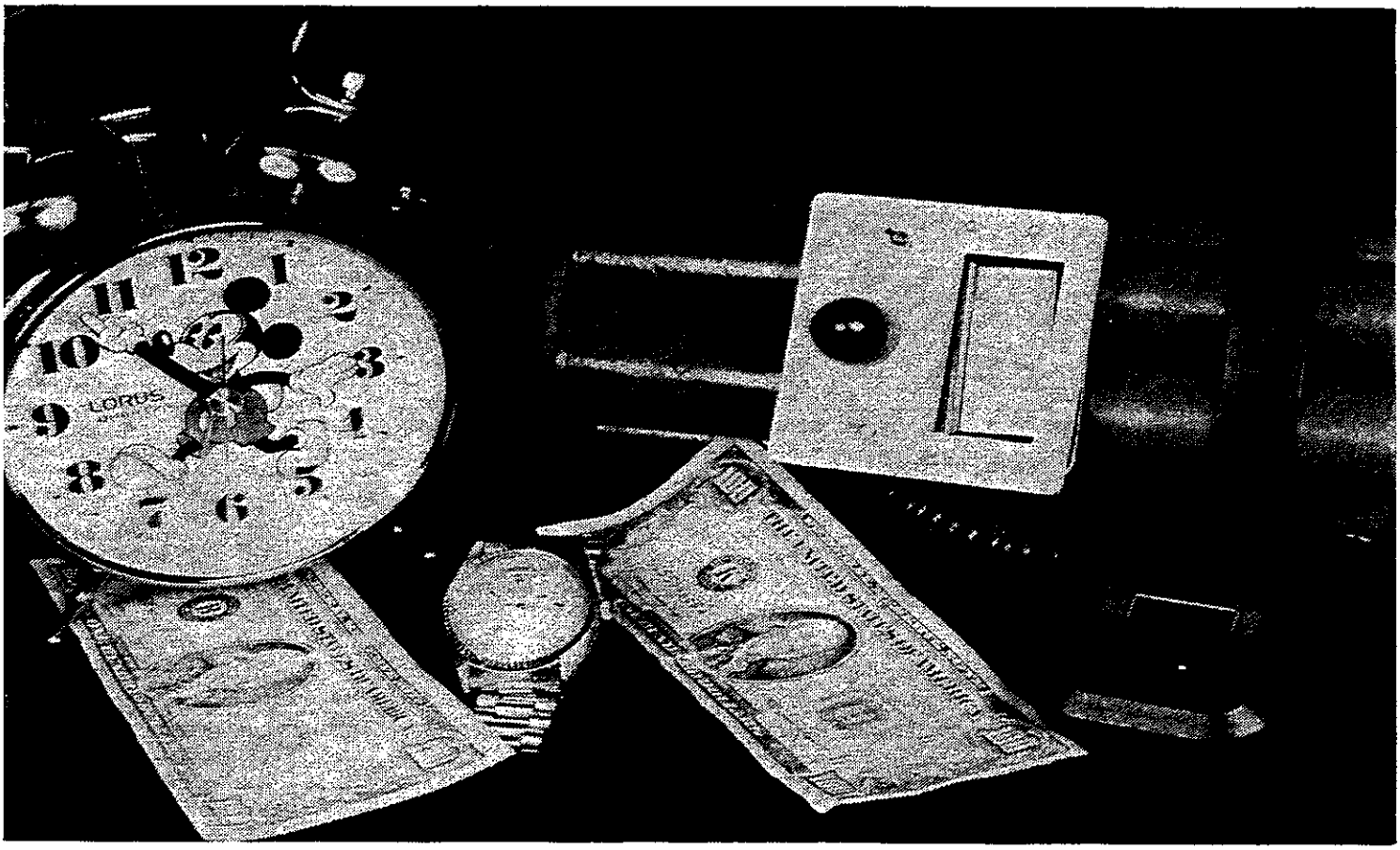
by
William T. Brooks
and
Dan S. Kennedy

EDITED BY • DAN S. KENNEDY



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Introduction

TIME is a very precious commodity to this book's co-authors, *BILL BROOKS* and *DAN KENNEDY*.

Both authors travel extensively on speaking and consulting activities, own and manage growing businesses, and have families.

Bill and Dan agreed that it's about time a time management book was written by people actually dealing with mammoth time pressures every day — and here it is.

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Who Knows What Time Is, Anyway?

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by Bill Brooks

Time is an enigma, a confusing array of myths, misconceptions and half truths that befuddles us all every now and then.

If you randomly ask 25 people for their definition of time, you may get 25 different answers. Some typical responses: time is a magazine, something you measure on clocks, scarce, etc.

Each of us has the same 168 hours a week to spend, yet it never seems to be enough. Many people understand time mathematically, but they have no concept of how it can be controlled.

This book is about you and your relationship with time, our most important non-financial resource. It may challenge some of your existent concepts about time.

Hopefully, the book will stir you to action because this book contains proven time management techniques that can help you increase your productivity and assist you in attaining your goals.

Misconceptions about time span every age and occupational group. Even reasonably effective and organized executives act as if they have an endless supply of time — and they're right; they have all the time there is and not one second more!

The executives also assume that things always get done — eventually! They bury their heads as years go by and time becomes their enemy rather than their ally.

Most people tend to take the path of least resistance in their everyday lives. We tend to do things that are quick, enjoyable, fun or easy before tackling jobs that are demanding, take a long time, are boring or difficult.

Using time to your advantage requires self-discipline and commitment. You must respond to self-imposed pressure in the same way as you would to deadlines and pressures imposed by bosses, your spouse or others. The rewards and benefits of effective time management are tremendous, and they can literally give you a new lease on life.

Let's take a short quiz and see how well you use your time.

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TIME USE QUIZ

	YES	NO
1. Do you have a list of your most important projects?		
2. Do you have a list of your highest priority projects?		
3. Do you feel that you have enough time for yourself?		
4. Do you feel that you use your time effectively?		
5. Do you always complete and forward paperwork when due?		
6. Do you have a clearly defined list of personal and professional objectives in writing?		
7. Do you always accomplish what needs to be accomplished daily?		
8. Do you feel that you squeeze every available minute from your day?		
9. Do you always have a set of weekly objectives in writing?		
10. Do you tackle difficult, demanding or unpleasant tasks without procrastinating?		
11. Do you complete business matters during business hours?		
12. Do you know what your time is worth by the minute?		
13. Do you have a five-year plan for personal/professional growth?		
14. Do you plan your day's activities the afternoon or evening before?		
15. Do you set objectives for major projects you want to accomplish?		
16. Do you feel that you spend enough time on formal professional training?		
17. Do you feel that you are earning your full potential?		
18. Do you spend most of your time on productive activities?		
19. Do you know how many productive hours you spend at work?		
20. Do you think that interruptions keep you from achieving your goals?		

SCORING KEY

Add all YES and NO answers. Determine your score below:

17 — 20	YES	You manage your time better than most people.
14 — 16	YES	You're headed in the right direction.
11 — 13	YES	You're spinning your wheels.
10 or more	NO	You need help — NOW.

The Clock of Life

Is wound but once
And no man has the power
To tell just when the hands will stop,
At late, or early hour.
NOW is the only time you own.
Live, love and toil with a will.
Place no faith in tomorrow —
For the clock may then be still.

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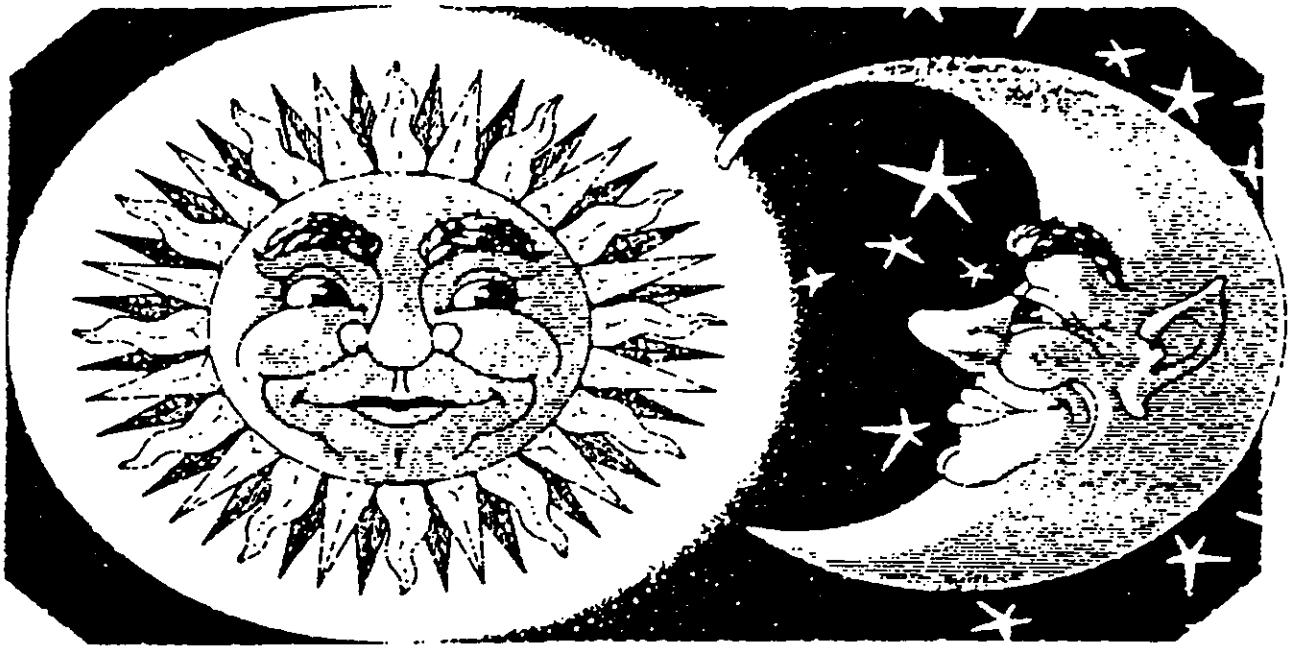

Time And You

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by Bill Brooks

There is nothing, not even money or burning desire, more critical to personal and professional success than the effective use of time.

Applying effective time management to your lives will probably be one of the biggest challenges you'll ever encounter, but its rewards can be staggering. Can you imagine what your life would be like if you had time for all the things that you've always wanted to do? That you could plan and organize your activities rather than have them run you?

The effective use of time can make a difference in your life. By setting realistic objectives, planning and prioritizing your activities and executing a plan of action, you can make time work for you — not against you.

The time management suggestions we offer are proven winners — and they work! They form a guide for planning and implementing your own personalized time management system.

When it comes to setting objectives and time management, we are more similar than different. Take the example of achieving goals: We all fall victim to "Murphy's Law"; things take longer than we think they will and that if something can go wrong (or delay us in meeting our objectives) it will.

Something known as the "real world" gets in the way of even our most carefully constructed plans. In the "real world" unclear objectives, shifting priorities, lack of planning, poor scheduling, telephone interruptions, bosses and meetings can constantly get in the way.

If you have any doubts about the impact of the "real world"; just ask yourself,"When was the last time that an unscheduled meeting with the boss or an unnecessary phone call threw me off schedule?".

Delays, detours and other time-devouring distractions can adversely affect our "achievement drive", a term coined by Ron Willingham, author of the sales book *The Best Seller*.

"Achievement drive" is the "want to", an internal motivator, the burning desire to win and succeed. What can affect our achievement drive? Stress hassles, disappointments, paperwork and other daily irritants can reduce and even kill the will to succeed.

Fortunately, there is a solution to this dilemma — time management. And, there is only one time to begin time management — NOW!

Out Of Control

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by Dan Kennedy

Not being in control of your time can be costly.

Bob Hope tells of a high-stakes golf match with his buddy, the late Bing Crosby. Bob was leading by five strokes on the 14th hole when he was called away, to deal with some urgency that simply "couldn't wait." Hating to lose out on his advantage over Bing, he asked Bing to finish the game himself, playing through for both of them.

Later that day, Bing called with the news that Bob owed him $500.00.

"How could that be?" Bob wanted to know. "When I left you, I had a five stroke advantage!"

"That's true," Bing agreed, "but after you left, your game just fell apart!"

The 15 Most Important Time Management Concepts

www.getwsodo.com

by Bill Brooks

Certain concepts are referred to throughout this book and they are basic to an understanding of time management. These concepts will help you plan and execute your own time management system tailored to your needs and objectives.

1. Activity Trap	Sometimes known as not being able to see the forest for the trees. We get so wrapped up in what we're doing we lose sight of why we're doing it.
2. Busyness	Do not get bogged down in details or activities surrounding an objective. It's what you accomplish that counts.
3. **Effective vs. Efficient**	**Effectiveness is doing the right job right.** Efficiency is simply doing a job right.
4. 80/20 rule (also known as Pareto's Principle)	80 percent of all results are derived from 20 percent of the effort; conversely, 20 percent of the results come from 80 percent of the effort.
6. Habit Patterns	Like other forms of behavior, time management is the result of habitual actions.
7. Interlocking Objective	A logically planned series of objectives leading into each other. Daily objectives should lead to the accomplishment of weekly ones, etc.
8. Management	Planning, organizing, motivating and supervising the competent performance of others.
9. Murphy's Laws	Everything takes longer than you think it will. Nothing is as easy as it seems. anything can go wrong, it will.

10. Parkinson's Law	Work expands to fill the time available for its completion.
11. **Planning**	**Determining what needs to be done.**
12. Priorities	A systematic arrangement of activities based on their order of importance.
13. **Proactive**	**Any positive movement toward the accomplishment of a goal.**
14. Scheduling	When to initiate planned activities/tasks.
15. Timewasters	Phone calls, unexpected visitors or anything that sidetracks you from the achievement of your goal.

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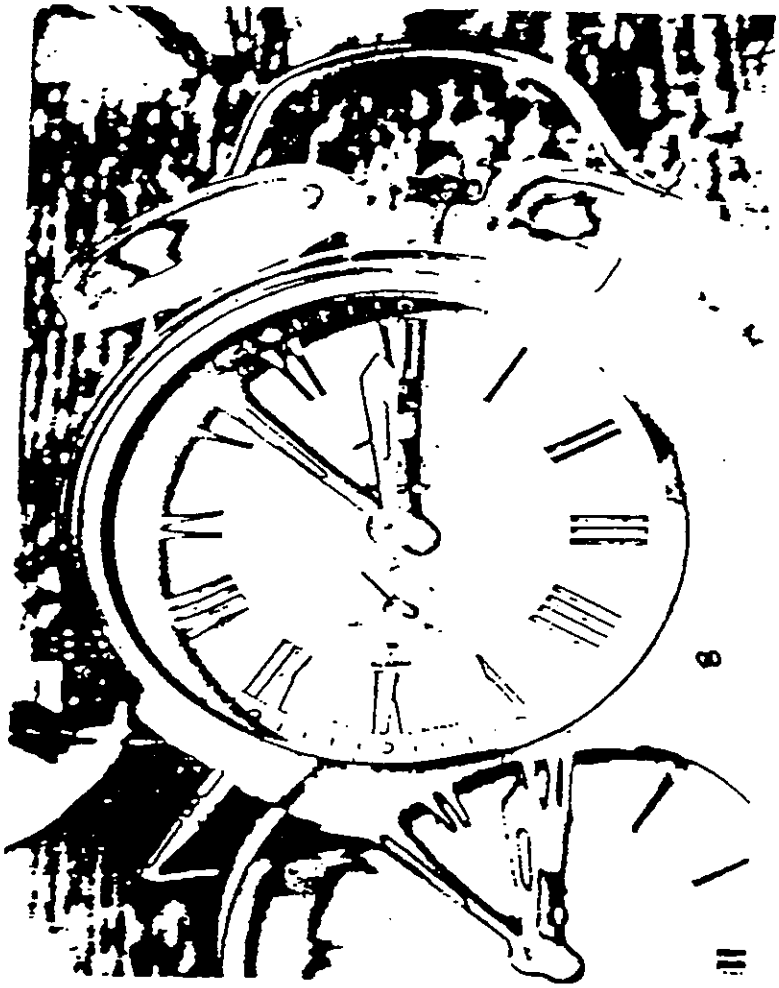

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Classic Thoughts About Time

Spending TIME Worrying

"My life has been full of terrible misfortunes, most of which never happened." — *Montaigne*

Management TIME

"If you want to kill an idea, get a committee working on it." — *Charles Kettering*

"How difficult it is to be simple!" — *Dr. Paul Gachet Van Gogh's psychiatrist*

Life-TIME

"If I had known I was going to live this long, I would have taken better care of myself." — *entertainer Phil Harris*

Night-TIME

"By night an atheist half believes in God." — *playwright Edward Young*

Friday

Robert Schuller, TV-minister and proponent of "possibility thinking", believes that made-in America mantras have so much power that the phrase TGIF: Thank God It's Friday may have sapped the national energy level and contributed to the decline of productivity.

Trapped In TIME

"Men are anxious to improve their circumstances, but are unwilling to improve themselves. They therefore remain bound." — *James Allen, Author AS A MAN THINKETH*

Who Do You Spend TIME With?

"Keep away from people who try to belittle your ambitions. Small people always do that, but the really great make you feel that you, too, can become great." — *Mark Twain*

Ask 3 Questions To Improve Productivity

www.getwsodo.com

by Bill Brooks

Most people tend to take the path of least resistance in their lives. They seek quick fixes to their problems — fast, painless solutions that cause them as little discomfort as possible.

In time management there are no quick fixes. Time management involves learning new habits and behaviors and taking positive action. And it requires self-discipline, the antithesis of easy answers.

The closest thing we have to a "pre-mixed" formula is the time use productivity test. The test consists of three questions you should ask yourself each time a task, function or activity is undertaken. If your answers aren't the correct ones, eliminate the activity.

QUESTION ONE

"WHAT IS THE MOST EFFECTIVE USE OF MY TIME RIGHT NOW?"

Efficiency and effectiveness are often used interchangeably, and that causes confusion. Efficiency means doing the job right. For example, it is repairing the coffeepot correctly. **Effectiveness is doing the right job right. It means selecting a job that's consistent with your goals and objectives and doing it right.** It means fixing the coffee pot only if it helps your ultimate objective.

Almost anyone can be trained to be efficient, but result-oriented people are more concerned with effectiveness than with efficiency. Why?

The following example illustrates the difference between efficiency and effectiveness. Suppose you had a goal of repairing your car's carburetor so that it would run without stalling. After several hours work, you take your car on a test drive and it doesn't stall. That's efficiency. Effectiveness was determining that the carburetor was responsible for the car stalling in the first place. And, once the determination was made, fixing the carburetor because it was necessary in achieving your first objective of getting to work on time.

Clear cut objectives are essential to effectiveness. They serve as a roadmap, directing you to the right job with a minimum of guesswork and wheel

spinning. Vague objectives won't do. They must be specific, measurable, written, your own, realistic, on a time schedule and consistent with each other.

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QUESTION TWO

"WHAT IS THE PAYOFF OF THIS ACTIVITY?"

Many of us spend time on activities that produce few results. Remember *Pareto's Principle* or the *80/20 Rule*? Simply stated, it says that 80 percent of your results come from 20 percent of your activities. In a sales force, for example, it means that 20 percent of the employees account for 80 percent of the sales. Or, on a baseball team, 20 percent of the hitters account for 80 percent of the runs batted in.

The same rule applies to your time. To avoid a lot of unproductive time use, keep this in mind: if an activity leads to the achievement of a planned, measurable objective, the payoff is clearly 80 percent; if it doesn't, the payoff must be 20 percent.

QUESTION THREE

"WHAT CELL AM I IN?"

Important and urgent are misused time management terms. Urgent deals with time; important deals with priority. When we respond to the urgent more quickly than we respond to the important, we are succumbing to the "tyranny of the urgent."

The following chart, originally developed by noted Time Manager Dr. Merrill Douglas, illustrates the problem:

		IMPORTANT: YES	IMPORTANT: NO
URGENT	YES	CRISIS 1	TRIVIAL 3
	NO	NOT HAPPENING (for most people) 2	WASTE 4

A crisis is something that's BOTH important and urgent. It is working on your monthly activity report 30 minutes before it's due.

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However, if something is important, but not urgent, it may not be happening for many people. Without an imposed time factor to make the activity more real, some salesmen, for example, may not prospect for new customers or personnel specialists may not keep abreast of the latest development in the human resources industry.

Items in Cell 3 — things that are urgent, but not important, are deceptive. They seem to be important, but they are actually trivial and they devour time. At the office, personal telephone calls, drop-in visitors, unnecessary meetings and other related events are among our most time wasting activities.

Obviously, if something is neither urgent nor important, it should be avoided. Spending too much time in Cells 3 and 4 delay the inevitable — sooner or later you'll be spending most of your time in Cell 1, going from crisis to crisis, wondering where all your time went. To avoid this dilemma, simply ask yourself all three questions.

Anything Worth Doing

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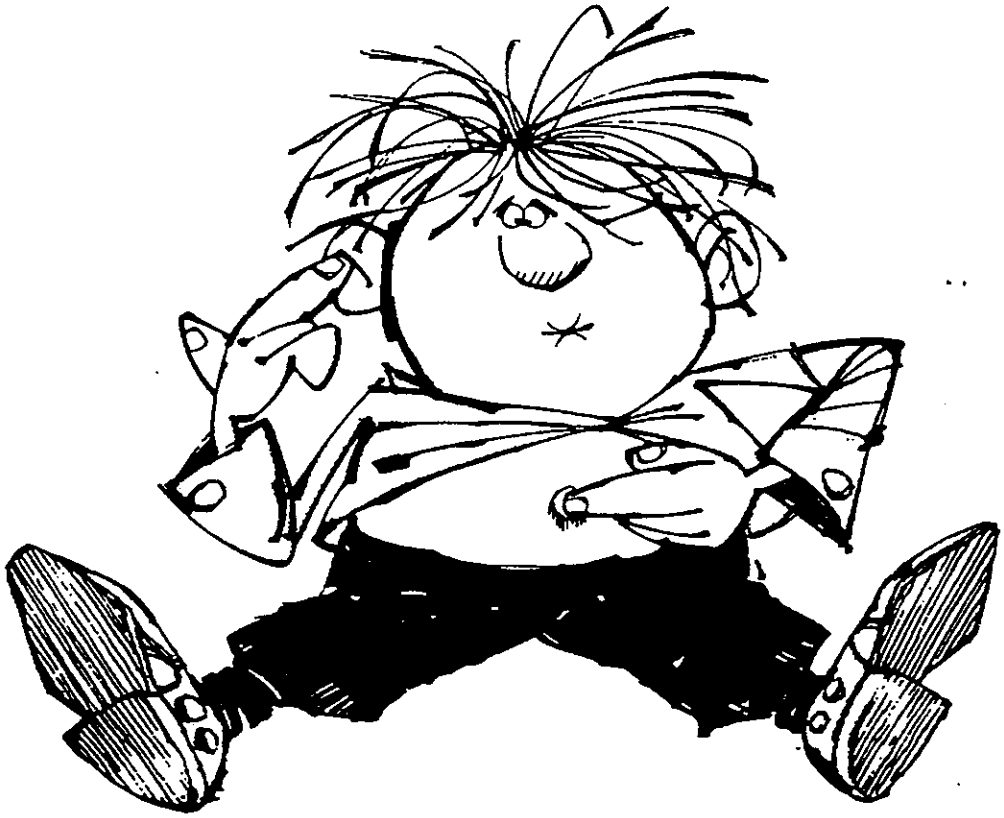
In the words of Peter Drucker, "Efficiency is doing things right; effectiveness is doing right things." ***Effectiveness*** **means working on things with a high payoff,** while *efficiency* does not necessarily draw that distinction. Unfortunately, many people work very hard, both on and off the job, at being efficient where the payoff is minimal, at best. **Many of us were raised with the old adage, "Anything worth doing is worth doing right." If we looked objectively at this statement, we might see that many of the things we are doing are not worth doing *at all*, much less "doing right", and that many things that are "worth doing" are really only worth doing *adequately*. For example, have you ever spent a considerable amount of time looking for a 50¢ error in your checkbook balance rather than just writing it off as an adjustment?** Or had a report completely retyped because of a minor typographical or spelling error? Or bruised your knuckles getting that one last spot covered with paint on your bathroom wall *behind* the toilet? You should concentrate *first* on being effective in what you do, and give your attention later to being efficient at it. Determining your payoff areas will increase your effectiveness by helping you select those goals where the potential payoff is high.

(reprinted from the book "GETTING YOUR ACT TOGETHER")



Common Time Management Challenges

www.getwsodo.com

by Dan Kennedy

The following brief Chapters each identify a common time management problem and discuss the most probable causes. When you understand the behavioral cause of a particular time management problem, you can effect deliberate changes in your actions and solve the problem.

Too Many Meetings, Too Much Time In Meetings

www.getwsodo.com

by Dan Kennedy

Meetings, meetings, meetings — some executives and entrepreneurs fall into the trap of letting meetings manage their time. One client-company that I've been consulting with for about six months is literally sacrificing at least half of its potential for growth, productivity and profit by involving all their key people in so many meetings that there's no time to take any action on anything decided in the meetings.

If you're spending too much time in too many meetings, there are four probable reasons:

1. **You can't say NO.** It's the nature of many success-oriented individuals to overcommit. There **are** finite limits to the number of committees you can serve on, activities you participate in, etc. before your effectiveness in **all** functions disintegrates.
2. **You pile up more information than you need.** Speed of decision-making is an important characteristic common to most top achievers. Executives from Andrew Carnegie to Lee Iaccoca advise that you need to limit the number of people involved in a given project; accept and work with less than 100% of all possible information; and, make the best possible judgements under these conditions.

   In his autobiography, Iaccoca said, "If I had to sum up in one word the qualities that make a good manager, I'd say that it all comes down to decisiveness." He went on to observe, "Obviously, you're responsible for gathering as many relevant facts and projections as you possibly can. But at some point you've got to take that leap of faith."
3. **You delegate reluctantly and ineffectively.** I believe you **should** stick your nose in every nook and cranny of your business frequently — but you can't keep it there constantly.
4. **You lack effective communication methods** in your organization. If a telephone call or memo will do, a meeting is probably "overkill."

What To Do To Reduce Time In Meetings

1. Say NO — don't go if you deem it unnecessary.
2. Delegate — send a substitute.
3. Use alternate, quicker communication options.
4. Plan and prepare and insist other participants do the same — have and adhere to an Agenda.
5. Have a "stand-up meeting."
6. Make meetings come to you - so you can keep working up until the last minute and start again as soon as it's over.

Managing The Information-Explosion

www.getwsodo.com

by Dan Kennedy

Welcome to the Information-Explosion! New "stuff" is coming at you in greater quantity, at a faster pace than was imaginable even a few years ago. The proliferation in good, worthwhile business and financial literature alone — books, magazines, newsletters, etc. — is overwhelming.

Here are some tips, and some services, that can help you benefit from more information in less time:

1. **Improve reading skills.** "Speed reading" is real, it can be learned and an excellent level of comprehension can be maintained while dramatically increasing speed.
2. **Cut down on time-consuming reading** that is of questionable value in achieving your goals.
3. **Convert wasted time to productive time**, by having a book, magazine or newsletter with you in case you have to wait for an appointment, start of a meeting, delayed flight, etc.
4. **Use your "drive time"** to listen to useful speeches, seminars, book condensations, etc. available on audio-cassettes. Just driving to and from your place of business and running errands, you probably spend more than 350 hours a year in your car, alone. Audio-cassettes allow you to turn that commuting time into learning time.
5. **Consider the use of "information summary services."** For example, *NEWSTRACK* provides summaries of important national and international news on convenient, timely audio-cassettes.
6. **Set aside and "bulk" material that is not time-sensitive, to review at your leisure.** Examples: catalogs, popular magazines, advertising material, etc. NEVER let such material interrupt your workday and command your attention during peak hours of productivity.

The Second Time Around

www.getwsodo.com

by Dan Kennedy

I find that a shocking amount of time is wasted repairing or re-doing the same work over again. Mistakes, of course, are going to happen — in fact, if no mistakes are happening, nothing else is either! But the quantity and frequency of errors must be monitored and minimized by the time-conscious manager.

One of the big causes of error is the communication/delegation process. Clear communication between two people is a very difficult thing to achieve, for any number of reasons: one or both of the parties not fully concentrating on the matter at hand; poor listening skills on the part of the delegatee; poor communication skills on the part of the delegator; the inherent opportunity for confusion in our English language as well as in the technical language of a particular business; and, of course, the pressures of time. The astute manager is aware of all this, reminds himself of it, and forces himself to take the time necessary to insure that his instructions are being clearly understood. A little extra time spent in the beginning will save a lot of time later. An ounce of prevention is worth an hour of cure! Also, the manager has to constantly train and coach his people to give feedback, so everybody can determine whether or not understanding is taking place. The single most difficult thing for a manager to deal with is the staffperson's "blank look."

Another cause of confusion that creates errors is inadequate procedures in place to handle routine matters. Re-inventing the wheel is a costly, irritating, energy-sapping activity. When it becomes apparent that procedures are ineffective, time should be taken quickly to correct the problem with an effective procedure — not a quick-fix bandaid.

Last, I'm personally convinced that employees' acceptance of responsibility for error-free work can be heightened through coaching, discussions and incentive programs. In the manufacturing portion of our business at General Cassette Corporation, for example, we have a monthly QUALITY CONTROL BONUS paid to staff-members based on error-free work. We pay out as much as six thousand dollars a year in bonus money to a qualifying group of only seven or eight people — and it has proven a very worthwhile investment.

When things are done right the first time, everyone involved has more time to do more things right.

How To Profit From a Time Analysis System

www.getwsodo.com

by Bill Brooks

Why should you bother to record your time? Why should you bother to analyze how you are spending your most valuable non-financial commodity? How can you apply what you learn from the analysis in your everyday life?

Those are three valuable and important questions. The answer is powerful: the insights you gain from a Time Use Analysis can help you transform the quality of your life. Time Use Analysis can assist you in determining your time use patterns. It can provide valuable information about how much productive, uninterrupted work you do each day. You can also see how well you delegate responsibility to others and how much time you spend on the telephone and handling paperwork.

A Time Use Analysis is one of the most useful tools in a time management system. Most people spend their time in predictable and habitual ways. In order to manage your time more effectively, you must **first** know how you are spending it. You'll probably be surprised to see exactly where your time goes!

Meetings, ringing telephones and the rigor of business travel combine to form a daily whirlwind routine of blurred activity. Each day seems to run recklessly into the next and before we know it the week is over, leaving us with the uneasy feeling that we didn't accomplish all that we wanted to.

We **can** do something about this. The best way to determine your personal time use habits is to record your time, for at least a one-week period, each quarter of the year. Time analysis requires some work, but its dividends far outweight its costs. Most people are surprised at how they use their time, and the analysis provides the information for you to align your activities closer to your objectives.

INSTRUCTIONS FOR COMPLETING YOUR TIME USE ANALYSIS

1. Write your name in the space indicated. Enter the day of the week (Monday - Friday) and the date.
2. **All the time is to be recorded in 15-minute blocks.** You may only do one thing in some time periods, while in others you may do four

or five tasks. Don't be too concerned about that. Try to capture the most important thing that you are doing.

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3. **Record your activities as you do them.** Don't wait until noon to record what you did at 9:00 am. You will forget.
4. Check the appropriate block to correspond with your activity.
5. Here is what is meant by activity:

• Meeting	Time actually spent in a meeting.
• Paperwork	Any time utilized handling paperwork; e.g., writing, reading memos, etc.
• Traveling	Time spent going to a business engagement.
• Waiting	Time spent in anticipation of an appointment that is running late, not starting on time.
• Interruption	Phone call, drop-in visitor, unscheduled hallway meeting, etc.
• Client/customer relations	Setting up appointments, customer service work, scheduled sales calls.
• Miscellaneous	Coffee breaks, trips to restroom, etc.

6. Complete the total for the day and determine percentage of time spent on each activity.

The results of Time Use Analysis can give your career and personal life a tremendous boost. After the study is completed, you can see how you spent your time. You may be surprised at how much time you literally wasted; time that could be spent in more productive ways.

You will also see how much time was spent in activities that contribute to your professional success. For example, real estate agents can determine how much time they spent inspecting properties, getting listings, talking with clients and other activities directly related to their income.

PRODUCTIVITY

is the use of your Time, Talent, Energy and Resources in a manner calculated to move you progressively closer to worthwhile goals.

— *Dan Kennedy*

TIME USE ANALYSIS

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Name _____ Day _____ Date _____

Meeting	Paperwork	Traveling	Waiting	Interruption	Client/Customer Relations	Miscellaneous

Ten Tips For Effective Planning

www.getwsodo.com

by Bill Brooks

The following guidelines take some of the mystery and uncertainty out of planning your objectives. Remember: the objectives must be yours, not dictated by someone else.

1. Write down a plan each week outlining key objectives for next week.

2. To successfully plan your time, answer four questions:
   a. What objectives do I want to accomplish?
   b. What must I do to accomplish these objectives?
   c. In what sequence should I complete them?
   d. How long will each of these activities take?

3. Planning takes some time, but saves a lot more.

4. Focus on results...not activities.

5. Planning is a habit, just as not planning is a habit.

6. Make sure your daily activities list contains priorities and time estimates for their completion.

7. Plan your daily activities the day before. Your day will begin on a high note.

8. Include personal time for yourself daily.

9. Good planners consistently get better results than non-planners or poor planners.

10. Two hours a day is often the difference between success and failure ...not luck, intelligence or hard work.

WEEKLY WORK PLAN

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Week of _____

Major Objectives for Week

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____
4. _____
5. _____

Projects Required to Accomplish Objectives

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____
4. _____
5. _____

Activities Required to Accomplish Projects

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____
4. _____
5. _____
6. _____
7. _____
8. _____

Is Time Money?

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This Chart, based on 8-hour workdays, shows you:

1. What each hour has to be worth, to achieve certain annual earnings.

2. What each minute has to be worth, to achieve certain annual earnings.

3. In a year, what one hour a day is worth.

IF YOU WILL EARN	EVERY HOUR IS WORTH	EVERY MINUTE IS WORTH	AN HOUR A DAY FRITTERED AWAY COSTS YOU — IN A YEAR
$ 20,000.00	$10.25	.1708	$ 2,500.00
$ 30,000.00	$15.37	.2561	$ 3,750.00
$ 50,000.00	$25.61	.4269	$ 6,250.00
$100,000.00	$51.23	.8523	$12,500.00

Everybody says "time is money", but how many people actually live as if time was money?

In Las Vegas, they take away your "real money" and give you brightly-colored chips to "play with." This is not caprice on the casino operators part; it's done for a very sound psychological reason. People tend to risk more, lose more and lose more cheerfully when operating with this play money than with the form of money they deal with in everyday life.

Similarly, because minutes, quarter hours, half hours, hours and days are not dispensed in the form of money — coins and bills — it's hard for us to feel the same way about spending time as we do spending money. The same person who gets confused in a dark cocktail lounge and leaves a $50-bill as a tip when he meant to leave a $5-bill, and feels awful about doing so, will think nothing about wasting an hour waiting in line or "shooting the bull" around the water cooler.

However, the fact is that time IS money. When you waste an hour, you might as well put some money from your pocket into an ashtray and set fire to it.

There is absolutely no doubt in my mind that an individual's income, career progress and other rewards are directly related to how much value he places on his time.

Setting Time Targets

www.getwsodo.com

by Bill Brooks

A product of the "Flower Power" generation of the 1960's and the "Me" generation of the 1970's, Jack is a firm believer in what he calls "living in the moment."

Although now in his late 30's, Jack has made it through life without thinking much, if at all, about objectives. He takes life as it comes and hopes for the best. Jack is not an extreme case in poor management — most people don't think about objectives. They simply respond to the events and circumstances that inevitably arise.

When Jack does think about objectives, it is in very vague terms. If you asked someone what their objectives are you'd probably get answers like "making money", "spending more time with my family", "taking a vacation." Although they seem like objectives, these generalities are not what time management is about.

Specific objectives do two things: [1] they motivate us to take action and, [2] they provide direction for that action. Specific objectives serve as a blueprint for action and they keep us on course.

The following guidelines will reduce the guesswork involved in setting objectives.:

1. **Objectives must be exact and measurable.**

   Clear cut objectives help us attain our goals by clarifying our thinking and plan of action. For example, simply stating that your objective is to earn more money is too vague. Replacing it with an objective of making $60,000.00 annually by next year is more precise and measurable.

   By attaching a value to your objective you are making it more measurable and real to yourself. That is the only way to know if you have achieved your objective.

2. **Put your objectives in writing.**

   How many times have you made an oral promise to yourself, only to break it shortly thereafter? The objectives could be something as innocuous as cleaning the garage or as major as changing careers.

Regardless of objectives, they all get their power in clarification, which is why they must be written.

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3. **Make the objectives yours.**

This may sound like common sense, but we all do things to please others. Ownership is a basic and powerful motivator, prodding us to set objectives we might not normally attempt.

4. **Set realistic objectives.**

Do not set objectives that you cannot achieve through inadequate preparation. Chances are you're not going to become a tournament-winning professional golfer if you're a 35-year-old man who can't tell the difference between a driver and a sand wedge.

Unrealistic objectives are damaging emotionally, and they can cripple your enthusiasm toward objectives you can achieve. Objectives represent a reasonable level toward which you are able and willing to work. They should not be comfortable, should force you to reach beyond your limits to attain them.

5. **Objectives must have a schedule and a time frame.**

Schedules and deadlines give an objective a greater sense of urgency. It's too easy to "let yourself off the hook" if your objectives do not have dates for completion, progress and benchmark evaluation times attached to them.

If you want to increase your income by $10,000.00 within 12 months, check your progress every three months and make the necessary adjustments.

6. **Set objectives that are consistent with each other.**

Conflicting objectives can reduce, even kill, your achievement drive. An example: George planned on finishing his MBA degree at a local college. He was also determined to spend more time with his family. Torn between conflicting objectives, he accomplished neither. But he did suffer a healthy dose of frustration in the process.

Sample Form

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OBJECTIVES TO BE ACHIEVED THIS QUARTER

Objectives must always be: Specific, Measurable, Realistic, Time Scheduled, Compatible and **Written**.

OBJECTIVES TO BE ACHIEVED	TARGET DATE	CHECK DATE(S)	NOTES

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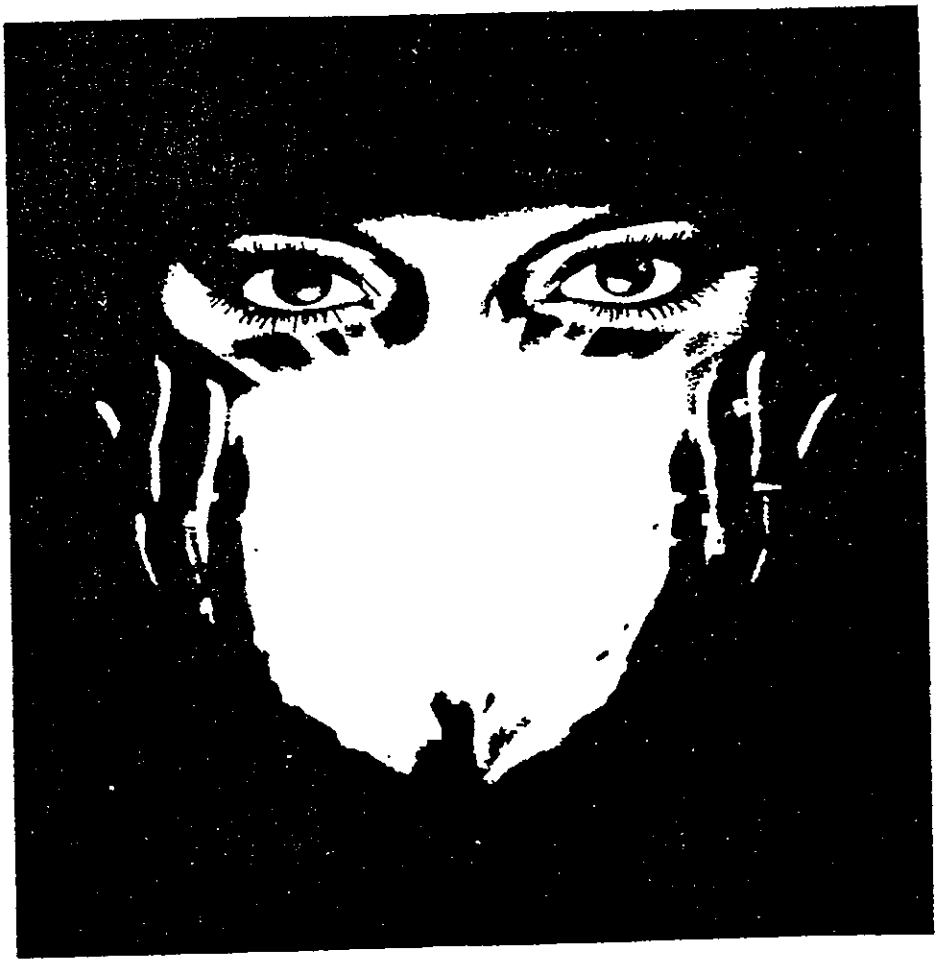
be a meaningful SPECIFIC instead of a meaningless GENERALITY



Strategies For Achieving Your Time Management Goals

www.getwsodo.com

by Bill Brooks

To most people, having goals is as natural as breathing. But having goals is one thing; following through on them, until they are accomplished, is another story.

Ideas and dreams come and go, but only a small percentage of people, research indicates 5 percent, consistently follow through on their goals until they become reality. Goal achievers exert pressure on themselves to persevere until their goals are attained. This requires self-discipline and vision, qualities that keep achievers on course when the going gets tough.

Achievers think and act differently from the vast majority of non-achievers. The difference between those people who get what they want and those who don't provides insights for all of us.

Achievers can visualize attaining their goals. They have mastered the art of building belief into their goals. Unlike the vast majority of people who don't believe anything that hasn't happened to them, goal achievers not only imagine but strongly believe in goals that logically seem unattainable.

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The Real Problem

by Dan Kennedy

One of the very real problems with time management is that time management is often not the problem.

The great personal growth lecturer, James E. Rohn, says that the reason people don't become millionaires is that they lack enough reasons to. I think that the reason more people don't manage their time more effectively is simply that they lack reasons to.

I'm often asked about time management because of my activities: I'm active in the management of six companies, have consulting clients, fulfill over a hundred speaking engagements a year, edit several newsletters, write and record several cassette programs a year, and still find time to take a vacation with my wife and daughter each year plus two or three other vacations with my wife and friends. Many people express awe and fascination at my ability to do all that. Frankly, a lot of it has to do with good time management skills and habits, developed and practiced out of necessity. And I think that IS the key — necessity. Most people that I observe have too little to do, not too much to do.

A major failing of many time management books, systems and disciplines is their separation from the issue of goals. Without a quantity of quality goals, no time methodology will work, because there's no motivating need to make it work.

Whenever I'm asked about time management by people having problems with time management, I always bring goals into the discussion. I believe that great goals cause effective time management.

Achieving Time Management Goals

www.getwsodo.com

by Bill Brooks

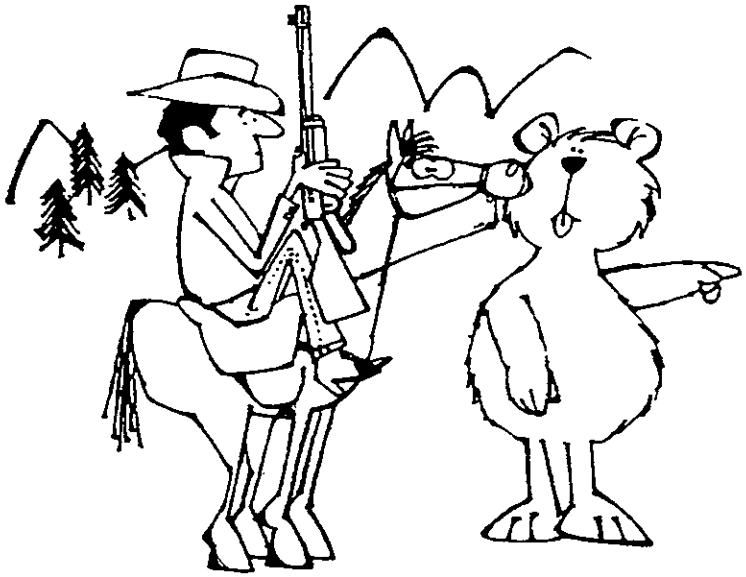
Achievers put their goals into written and organized form, a roadmap to success they personally create. They manage their time according to their goals which are divided into daily, weekly and monthly steps.

A key point to remember is that all three steps in the goal setting process are interlocked — one is a prerequisite to the next.

There's nothing complicated about setting goals. Simply ask yourself: "What do I want?" and "What don't I want?". These questions can help you decide on any kind of goal, including how you want time management to work for you and the amount of time and effort you are willing to put into changing your time use patterns.

Once you have a list of goals, divide it into three categories: [1] long term (ten years from now), [2] medium term (five years or so) and [3] short term (next year). Each of your related list of objectives has an affect on how you spend your time tomorrow, next week and next month.

Together, the written plan, goal plan and time management outline are tools you can use to achieve any goal you desire.



How To Eliminate Time Wasting Activities

www.getwsodo.com

by Bill Brooks

Timewasters! The "helpful" neighbor who knocks on your door with the latest tidbit of neighborhood "news." A co-worker who comes into your office with a question about hotel rates in Boston. The question might be plausible if you're going to Boston with him, but you're not. You're working on next year's departmental budget and the visit has thrown your work off course. These are two very real examples of the same thing — interruptions.

Interruptions are Timewasters' activities that lower productivity and our Achievement Drive, among other things. The problem is that most people don't think about interruptions too often. We are aware of them, in a vague way, but we ignore what they cost in reduced motivation, delays and mismanagement.

Although there are few sound scientific studies on the subject, we would estimate that 3.5 hours of each 8-hour workday are consumed by interruptions! Spread over the entire United States economy, time wasting is a multi-billion-dollar-a-year problem. Dealing with Timewasters is a major time management problem.

THE TOP 10 TIMEWASTERS ARE:

1. Telephone Interruptions
2. Drop-in Visitors
3. Ineffective Delegation
4. Meetings
5. Lack of Objectives
6. Crisis Management
7. Attempting Too Much At Once
8. Personal Disorganization
9. Procrastination
10. Lacking the Ability to Say No

To better understand Timewasters, it is important to record them. It is critical to understand who or what causes the interruptions. How long do they last? How much of the day is consumed by Timewasters? What can be eliminated?

The following Timewaster Analysis Record can help answer all those questions. A partially completed sample is prepared for your use.

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TIMEWASTER ANALYSIS RECORD

Salesperson's Name _____ Date _____

START	END	TOTAL TIME	PERSON	VISIT/ PHONE	REASON
9:00	9:10	10	Joe	Phone	Improper date for convention
9:35	9:50	15	Mary	Visit	Office gossip
9:55	10:00	5	Bob	Visit	Tell me a joke
10:10	10:40	30	Joe	Phone	Unscheduled meeting

Waste Not, Want Not

www.getwsodo.com

by Dan Kennedy

Once, right before starting an all-day seminar, I was told about a particular Indian tribe's philosophy that each person is born with a set supply of words to speak. As soon as you've used up your supply — poof! — you're gone. I went ahead and did the all-day seminar, but I've often thought about that idea since that day, and have tried not to waste as much time and as many words speaking to people who really don't want to hear what I have to say.

www.getwsodo.com

Controlling Personal Telephone Calls

by Bill Brooks

Can anything good be said about personal telephone calls at the office? From productivity and time management standpoints, definitely not.

Personal phone calls are a nuisance, a disruption and they cause frustration. They are also one other thing — unavoidable. Try as we may, chances are we'll always get calls from our wives asking us to stop at the cleaners on the way home or calls from our stockbroker with the latest market tips.

Despite their inevitability, there's no reason why you have to be inundated with calls at the office. You can manage your time more effectively by keeping the following points in mind:

- Have your secretary qualify your calls. Tell him/her the kind(s) of calls you'll accept and take no others.

- If you don't have a secretary, have an answering machine answer your phone. In your recorded message, ask the caller to leave the time, nature of the call and when they would like it returned. Once you know what the call is about, you can answer it when it fits **your** schedule.

- Set aside a block of time each day to answer personal calls. Lunchtime or late afternoon are good times to place the calls.

- Enlist the support of others. Tell them you are trying to use your time more effectively and why. Ask family, friends and others not to call you at the office.

Reducing Paperwork

www.getwsodo.com

by Bill Brooks

American business seems to be buried under heaps of paperwork. Some paperwork is necessary to the effective operation of companies and households while other paperwork cannot be justified on any grounds.

Paperwork is a creature of tradition and habit. Some paper may cross your desk because it always has — maybe your predecessor wanted to see it and it was automatically passed on to you.

You will manage your time more effectively by choosing your own paperwork procedures. In the process, you may find yourself delegating authority and responsibility to others who can help you reduce the flow of paper crossing your desk. Here's how:

- Dictate key thoughts and have someone else compose the letter.
- Get someone to handle routine correspondence.
- After initial sorting, handle paper only once.
- Paperwork doesn't have to be perfect — only adequate.
- Complete tasks before putting them down.
- Answer letters by making handwritten responses in the margin before having them typed.
- Place paperwork in files, not piles.

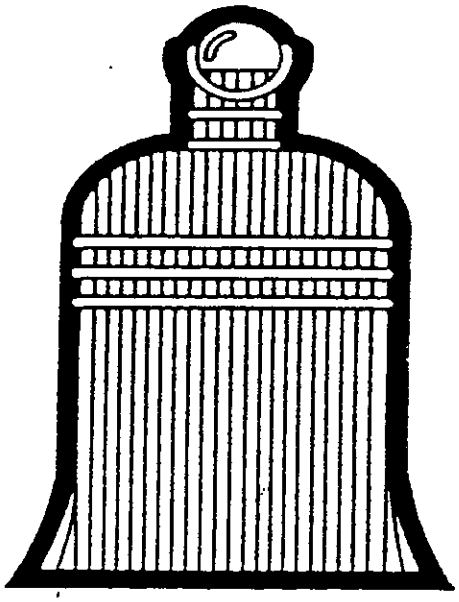
When In Doubt, Throw It Out!

www.getwsodo.com

by Dan Kennedy

Clutter drains energy, causes confusion and wastes time. Most people are "compulsive keepers" — mired in information that **may** be needed ...someday.

I've found that a little bit of ruthlessness toward paperwork is an advantage. For a number of years now, whenever I've had a question about where or why to store a particular periodical, file, set of correspondence, etc., I've forced myself to discard it. So far, out of literally thousands of questionable items discarded, only two have subsequently been needed.



www.getwsodo.com

Building Self-Confidence

by Bill Brooks

Self-confident people have an aura about them, an infectious "can do" attitude that makes almost anything possible. This type of confidence is vital to planning and executing a time management system.

Confidence is based on achievement and knowledge of your abilities. Salespersons who close major deals know they can do it again; they have a track record to back up their belief.

Self-confidence and persistence are closely related in the objective-setting process. Confident people who believe in themselves aren't likely to give up on a project when the going gets tough.

Motivational researchers have identified five traits that contribute to a high level of self-confidence. These traits can be developed by anyone in practically any situation:

1. **Confident people focus and build on their strengths.** They realize that each of us has our own areas of expertise and weakness. Hemingway could write eloquently and Jack Nicklaus is an excellent golfer, but neither is a violin virtuoso.

2. **Confident people don't waste time or energy comparing their weaknesses to someone else's strengths.** Instead, they concentrate on what they do best and they find as many ways as possible to use their talents.

3. **Reduce or eliminate negative influences in your life.** Surround yourself with successful, goal-oriented people. Spend time with family, friends and associates who respect you, believe in you and want you to succeed. Don't waste time on petty, negative people with modest goals and little self-motivation. They will attempt to drag you down to their level.

4. **Learn from others.** Invite a successful person to lunch and pick up the tab. These informal "brain picking" sessions are a great opportunity to find out how they became and stay successful. Success is contagious, and these meetings can save you a lot of trial and error if you're willing to listen and learn.

5. **Ignore unjustified criticism.** Effective time managers had to learn

how to use their advantage. And they were probably criticized in the process. Maybe they were accused of being gruff, abrasive or inconsiderate when they were trying to reduce interruptions or practicing other time management techniques.

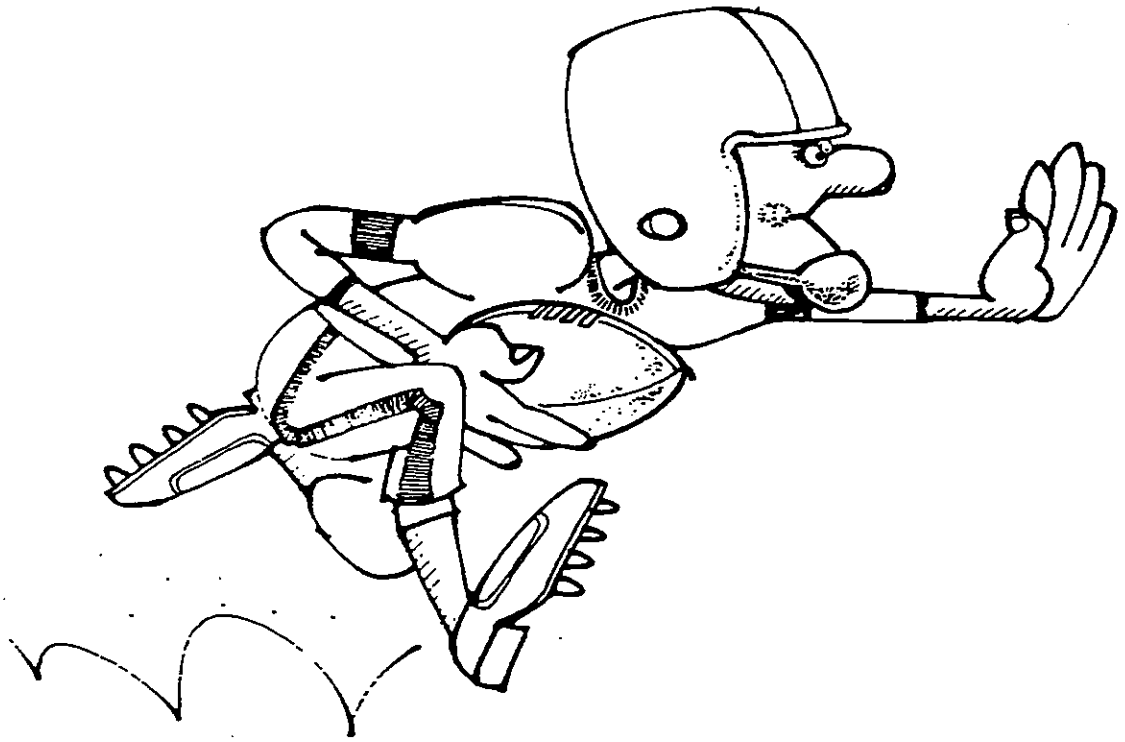
www.getwsoftp.com

6. **Criticism from people you trust and respect can help you grow,** but be leery of criticism from people who don't have your best interests at heart. The more successful and visible you become, the more criticism you'll get from people who are envious of your success. Be prepared for it!

7. **Prepare** yourself to be great. This concept can be broken down into a single word — PRACTICE. Good preparation compensates for a host of shortcomings.

Hall of Fame pro quarterback, Johnny Unitas, was a slow and plodding runner, but a deadly passer who excelled at reading defenses. An opposing coach once said of Unitas, "All he could do was pass and win. My mother runs faster and is more agile than he is."

Unitas was a winner and you can be, too, with a self-confident attitude.



Developing Persistence

www.getwsodo.com

by Bill Brooks

As you've probably seen by now, time management requires dedication and persistence, the qualities most successful people share.

Take Henry Ford, for example. Ford went broke five times before founding the motor car company that bears his name today. The millions of Fords on roads throughout the world are tributes to persistence and the benefits and rewards it can bring.

Surprisingly, Ford wasn't that much smarter, talented or gifted than other people. But he worked harder, longer and was less willing to settle for anything other than the best.

Evidence also indicates that successful people react differently to frustration, discouragement, doubt and failure than other people. The stories of Thomas Edison and Abraham Lincoln are legendary because they overcame failure and other adversity to affect world history.

Edison suffered through hundreds of failed experiments before perfecting the incandescent light bulb. Lincoln failed in business, had personal setbacks and was defeated for political office before being elected President.

Lincoln, Edison and other achievers weren't born with a gene marked persistence; they developed it and so can you. It is a skill that can be learned and a habit of thought that can be mastered.

The first step is to have powerful goals that you **NEED** to achieve. The goals must be stronger than the fear and obstacles you'll encounter along the way.

Goals you badly have to achieve serve as rallying points that help you work your way through problems, detours and disappointments you meet on the road to accomplishment.

The foundation of persistence is a strong belief in yourself, your goals and your work. Persistent people are enthusiastic about their lives and objectives, and they let their enthusiasm show. By enthusiasm we don't mean the rah-rah stuff found at football pep rallies, but rather the conviction that what you do is important.

Persistence can also be developed by focusing on results, not problems. When faced with a new problem or challenge, most people give reasons why it can't be solved; they don't bother with finding a solution. Rather than concentrate on victory, they opt for defeat by finding excuses, not answers.

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Persistent people tend to be risk takers who put themselves on the spot. Successful people know that to achieve big goals they must stick their necks out. Some forms of risk — financial, emotional or personal — are found in the life of every great achiever.

Sometimes successful people **HAVE TO BE** successful — they have few other alternatives. They burned bridges behind them so thoroughly that their only route of escape was victory. Many successful entrepreneurs invest their life savings in their businesses with victory or bankruptcy the only two possible outcomes.

With these methods, you can become more persistent. You can develop a pattern of completing projects, accomplishing objectives, solving problems and overcoming obstacles.

In Combat With Procrastination

www.getwsodo.com

by Bill Brooks

A silent and potentially deadly thief, procrastination is a major time management challenge.

Symptoms of procrastination, or the "I'll do it tomorrow syndrome", are everywhere. The symptoms include placing the trivial over the important, doing the safe and comfortable rather than the unknown and postponing happiness that comes from completing a meaningful project.

Procrastination can stop a career cold, and it robs of us time and energy that can be put to more productive and satisfying uses. Procrastination is learned behavior that takes time to develop and, once in place, it is hard to shake.

Research studies show that delayed tasks fall into three categories: jobs that are unpleasant; jobs that are difficult; and those jobs that make us feel indecisive.

Since we learn how to procrastinate, we can also learn how to stop it. The first thing to do is to simply admit that you procrastinate. The admission may be difficult or embarrassing, but you can't solve a problem by denying its existence. That's what Jacqui S. did two years ago and her life hasn't been the same since.

Jacqui S. was never one to meet an unpleasant task head on, but what she saw in a mirror, after a pasta dinner one December night, was a sobering experience.

Jacqui had gained 30 pounds in two years, excess weight that was sapping her strength and vitality. She had to lose it — or else. Losing 30 pounds seemed impossible until she decided to break the diet down into smaller, more manageable units. Her goal was to lose the weight over a five-month period, an average of 1½ pounds a week or six pounds a month.

Jacqui felt that the objective was realistic and the timetable could be met. To make the objective more real to her, Jacqui put it in writing and, as an added incentive, she planned a weekend vacation for herself after the first 30 pounds were off.

She also sought the support of family and friends, many of whom had

teased her about her weight gain. By asking for support, Jacqui put pressure on herself because she feared what would happen if the weight weren't lost. Her fears were apparently groundless — the last we heard from Jacqui she was in Bermuda.

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Jacqui's case highlights everything you need to do to stop procrastinating: breaking a big job into smaller parts makes it less awesome and formidable. Setting and sticking to guidelines are essential in handling unpleasant tasks because deadlines spur action.

Putting deadlines into writing makes them less abstract and gives the project an urgency and immediacy it might not otherwise have.

Rewards are a powerful stimulant to completing a project. Make the completion of a major job an event. Splurge if you get the urge; indulge your whims.

There is another way of handling jobs you'd rather not do — delegate them to others. If you dread writing letters, but your secretary is good at it, let her handle that chore. Delegating responsibilities to a trusted subordinate or colleague gives you more time to focus on the things you do best.

Game Called Because Of Rain

www.getwsodo.com

by Dan Kennedy

Holly died at age 16. Hodgkins Disease — a rather unpredictable form of cancer.

I know another lady; an indomitable, innovative, occasionally controversial schoolteacher who has had the same disease for over ten years, has frequent radiation treatments, and still climbs mountains and rafts rivers for recreation. May she live forever.

But Holly went quickly, just weeks from diagnosis to death. She was a bright, almost too-perky girl with big "Orphan Annie" eyes, blond hair, a nicely developing figure and an endearing shyness. She genuinely liked her after-school secretarial job in my office. Then the day came that she even lacked the strength to climb the single flight of steps to the office.

What can you say to her parents? What can you say to yourself?

She never had a chance to succeed, to fail, to risk, to commit a crime or commit to marriage, to experience love or lust, to do much of anything. 16 is a young age.

Why her life was called off in the early innings is beyond mortal comprehension. And, it's not particularly important to you. What IS important is YOUR life. Will you waste it, take it for granted, fritter it away in trivial pursuits?

It is an irritant for me to see a person do that. *Better they should have gone and Holly stayed.*

Whose Fault Is It, Anyway?

www.getwsodo.com

by Dan Kennedy

I just heard that George Burns signed a brand new ten year contract with a major Las Vegas hotel and casino. That tells you something about how George THINKS about time.

Our attitudes about time have more to do with our level of accomplishment than anything else. Even the most sophisticated, comprehensive set of time management tools and systems can't help the person who is convinced he can't manage time.

We all want control. The business owners in my audiences all want greater control over their businesses, their employees, their salespeople, their customers, their costs, their profits and their finances. They say to me: "Sometimes it seems like this business is running me instead of me running the business!"When things seem like they're out of control, it's a good idea to look at how they got that way. Every time you say, to yourself or aloud: "It's that darned Division Manager....it's that new competitor with the big ad budget....it's the season...it's Reagonomics....it's all these interruptions....it's...." — every time you say that, you do two things. One: you move a little square foot of responsibility away from you, and that makes you very temporarily feel better. Two: at the same time, you give away an equal amount of control. And, if you do it very much, very soon things WILL be literally out of control.

Responsibility and control are irretrievably linked. You can't have one without the other. If you want more control, accept more responsibility.

The High Jump

www.getwsodo.com

by Dan Kennedy

This monkey escaped from the zoo and bumbled right into a fox hunt. I'm not real popular at fox hunts, by the way; I usually get caught cheering for the fox.

Anyway, the fox ran past the bewildered monkey. Then came the dogs. The dogs spotted the monkey about the same time the monkey spotted the dogs, and it was anything but love at first sight. Those dogs took off after that monkey with renewed vigor and enthusiasm, snarling, drooling and snapping their teeth together. And that monkey took off like a track star. This monkey was a sprinter, not a marathon runner, and he quickly figured out that he was not going to out-run the dogs for very long. In fact, they were getting closer and closer by the second. Up ahead was a tree — salvation for the monkey. But someone had trimmed off all the lower branches on the tree, and the lowest branch was at least ten feet in the air.

The dogs at his heels, that monkey gave it one last burst of everything he had and made a flying leap at the branch. And missed.

But he caught it on the way down.

Sometimes it's worth setting your sights even higher than they need to be, so you can catch the goal on the way down.

A Good Excuse

www.getwsodo.com

by Dan Kennedy

I believe that five minutes early is on time, and strive to be early for every meeting or appointment.

Most people fail this test of punctuality frequently, and are always in need of a good reason for being late. Here's one you might like:

A commando leader called his battered troops together and gave them the latest news. "Tomorrow we are going to be involved in the toughest, bloodiest battle ever. The enemy already knows we're coming and they're bringing in plenty of reinforcements. There may be fifty of them for every one of us. I'm also told that our planes may not have enough fuel to get back...if there are any survivors. Now, we leave at 0800 hours sharp. Anybody who's late will be left behind."

A Little Is Too Much

www.getwsodo.com

by Dan Kennedy

The merchant was traveling across the desert on his camel, leading a caravan. One night, as it occasionally does, it suddenly got quite cold in the desert. The cold drove the camel to the entrance of the merchant's tent. The camel begged only to warm his nose inside the tent. Of course, you can guess what happened. Little by little, the camel inched in his head, then his shoulders, then his humps, until he filled the tent — shoving the merchant out into the cold.

That's exactly how Procrastination creeps into our lives — inch by inch, bit by bit. Each time you procrastinate, it takes another square foot of your life. Finally, procrastination fills your life, and you're on the outside, wrestling to get back in control.

Disorganized?
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It's The Government To The Rescue

by Dan Kennedy

I've got the answer to every business owner's dreams - how to finally get organized!

There is a brand new group of experts entering the business of helping business get organized via business seminars with titles like "How To Increase Productivity And Eliminate Waste" and "How To Maximize Efficiency" - and guess who the experts are? Your friends at the United States Postal Service. No, this is not a joke. The U.S. Postal Service has a division called Professional Business Seminars offering these wonderful programs at various locations across the United States.

Making sport of this is no fun. The postal service is too easy of a target. And carping about the impropriety of a government bureaucracy using taxpayer dollars to compete with and steal income from private enterprise, in an area of business it has no right to be in, well, that's been done too many times before. So, rather than convulsing with laughter or anger, I decided to view this remarkable piece of business news with an open mind and, as a result, I'm delighted to inform you that I have figured out how to resolve the national debt in one fell swoop. Are you ready? We'll have every government agency get into the public seminar business. Each agency will support itself with the extra income from its spare time seminaring, thus ending the need for any money from taxes. In a few years, the national debt will be paid off and income tax can be repealed. Maybe there'll even be profits and each former-taxpayer, now shareholder, can get a dividend check.

Here are a few seminar ideas for the Feds to consider:

The Pentagon can conduct Prudent Purchasing seminars. The IRS can compete with the Dale Carnegie people with seminars on Winning Friends And Influencing People. The White House could offer The Ronald Reagan Official Memory Course, the George Bush Seminar On Creative Imagery And Symbolism For Writers And Speakers and, of course, the Dan Quayle Remedial Reading Seminar. There might even be a market for The Wilbur Mills School Of Dance or the Jim Wright Seminar On Entrepreneurship.

There is only one problem with this idea. Each of these seminars has to be aggressively advertised and promoted to the business community and the public at large, and the most effective way to market seminars has always been direct-mail. This means that the postal service will be flooded with noxious "junk mail" to deliver. They'll undoubtedly respond as they do now by dumping huge quantities of it in tenement buildings, land fills and

delivering the rest of it late. This will undermine the success of the seminars and cause the cost of filling the seats to skyrocket, forcing the government to raise seminar ticket prices so high they'll price themselves out of the market. Before we know it, they'll need a low interest SBA loan or a government grant just to keep on offering the seminars and we'll be right back where we started.

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Maybe this isn't such a good idea after all.

Best Excuses For Being Late For Work

I ate so much during the holidays that none of my clothes would fit me so I had to spend all morning having them altered.

★

My husband's car wouldn't start so I had to take him to work.

★

My parrot finally spoke, so I waited for him to do it again so I could tape record it. At noon, I gave up and came to work.

★

My horoscope said that travel in the morning hours this week was dangerous.

★

My cat was depressed. I had to cheer her up.

★

I was sitting at the kitchen table with my morning cup of coffee, thinking about ways I could do my job better and I guess I lost all track of time.

★

The llama got loose from our backyard and I had to catch it.

★

I thought Halloween was a holiday.

Fax It - Fast!

www.getwsodo.com

by Dan Kennedy

Every month, BUSINESS MONTH MAGAZINE takes a Fax Poll of its readers on a specific topic or subject. There's a one page survey to fill out, then you FAX it - not mail it - in to the magazine's offices. The March 1990 FAX POLL says a lot about the present and future problems with our economy, American business and the neo-quality of the goods and services we get from American business and workers. The title of this Fax Poll is: ARE YOU SURROUNDED BY IDIOTS?

Of course, your immediate response is: what an idiotic question. Look around, for God's sake.

But BUSINESS MONTH explains itself. They say: We're talking about rank-and-file workers who can't read. Supervisors who can't solve a problem. Vice presidents whose written reports are the office joke. How much do these problems hurt your company?

The fact is that there's nearly 30 million Americans in the job market who can't read and probably twice that many who can't reason their way through a simple math problem - you remember the kind: if the farmer rows his raft across the river with four hens and a pig on it... All this is the tip, not the iceberg. There are more illiterates and incompetents flooding our workplaces with each graduating class. And our academic community has adopted the classic solution: when all else fails, lower the standards. I have a modest proposal for a long-term solution. First, tough annual competency test for kids. Those who fail stay back. Two, teachers who prove incompetent by having failing students get fired. Three, parents who prove incompetent by having failing students pay triple property taxes.

Well, what's funny about all that? Nothing. What I find funny is the discussion of this with a Fax Poll. It is remarkably symbolic of what has brought us here. With each passing day, we invent a new and better way to communicate faster. There was a Federal Express - on the desk at the opposite end of the world by 10:30 the next morning no matter what. That wasn't quick enough, hence the Fax. We also have the cellular, portable phone. Car phones weren't good enough. A call might still wait ten or twenty minutes while you stopped to go to the bathroom or swallow a styrofoam burger. No, you have to have your phone with you at all times so you can respond instantly. As we've sped up communication, we've stopped communicating. So Faxes are written and sent by illiterates. Cellular phone calls are made by people who can't string words together in a complete sentence. And computers are inputted by people who can't figure out how many hens the farmer sold before coming back across the river.

Which causes problems like one at a hotel I recently stayed in. The Faxed

memo from on high came in reminding everybody that all rooms must be cleaned by 11:00 AM. So, even though the posted check-out time was noon, maids, porters and managers drove irate guests from their rooms by ten, so they could get all the rooms cleaned by eleven. Then the front desk kept them clean and empty for three hours because check-in time was not until two. Of course, the Faxer meant to say that all **empty** rooms should be cleaned by eleven. But he goofed. The Faxees were all unable to think for themselves and only conditioned to respond fast to fast communication with fast action. And the front desk people - well, anybody who travels knows all about the front desk people.

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Somewhere, I think in a little coffee shop in rural Ohio, I recall see a hand-sewn sampler hanging on the wall, embroidered with the message: haste makes waste.

I've got a few more thoughts on this, but I've got to cut it short. It seems I've got a FAX coming in and it must be urgent or it wouldn't have been FAXED in the first place. Right?

A Few More Thoughts About Time

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PLAN AHEAD

One mountaineer said to the other: "Well, we almost lost our lives on this climb but now it's going to be worth it. Let's plant the flag."

"I thought you brought it."

★

NOWADAYS...

It takes all the running you can do to keep in the same place. If you want to get somewhere else, you must run at least twice as fast.

(From 'Alice In Wonderland')

★

WHY MOST PEOPLE ARE UNHAPPY

There are 24 hours in a day and only one is called the happy hour.

★

ABOUT TAKING ACTION

'I believe in men who take the next step, not those who theorize about the 200th step."

- Theodore Roosevelt

★

TIME FLIES WHEN...

'It's been 24 hours since I last heard from my creditors, and yet, it seems like only yesterday."

- George Marentis in 'Quote Magazine'

★

PROBLEM-SOLVING

From Jim Fowler of 'Wild Kingdom': "If you want to get a rhinoceros into a cage when it has never been in a cage before, you have to be innovative and try to reason like you think the rhinoceros might."

About The Authors

www.getwsodo.com

William T. Brooks is CEO of The Brooks Group, one of America's busiest firms specializing in performance training systems. For almost two decades, he has been one of America's most sought after speakers and consultants.

The author of six books, hundreds of audio and video programs, software and assessment products, Mr. Brooks' learning systems are utilized by hundreds of firms worldwide.

A catalog of Mr. Brooks' learning products is available from:

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Information about Mr. Brooks' services as a keynote speaker, seminar leader or consultant is also available through the above address.

About The Authors

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Dan S. Kennedy is a busy entrepreneur, direct marketing consultant, and professional speaker. He is the author of over a dozen books, including those listed below available in bookstores. As a speaker, mostly on marketing-related subjects, Dan addresses over 100,000 people a year, frequently appearing on programs with other famous speakers like Zig Ziglar, Jim Rohn, Rev. Robert Schuller and Paul Harvey, sports personalities like Coach Lou Holtz and Joe Theisman, and even two former U.S. Presidents, General Norman Schwarzkopf and General Colin Powell.

For a Free copy of Dan's unique book-alog, presenting all of his books, cassettes, business tool kits, consulting and speaking services - "Yes, You Can Get Rich Fast" - simply FAX a brief note anytime to 602/269-3113 or call Dan's office 602/997-7707.

Available in Bookstores or 1-800-223-7180:

1. The Ultimate Marketing Plan (published by Adams)
2. The Ultimate Sales Letter (published by Adams)
3. The Ultimate No B.S., No Holds Barred, Kick Butt, Take No Prisoners and Make Tons Of Money BUSINESS Success Book
4. The No B.S. SALES Success Book

Appendix

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Here is a convenient list of references and resources about time, including those mentioned in the book.

1. NEWSTRACK, INC. publishes current news and financial information on audio-cassettes. They also offer a series of 2-cassette-pack biographies of business and industrial leaders. For information, write: NEWSTRACK, Box 1178, Englewood, Colorado, 80150.

2. TIME MANAGEMENT FOR THE SALES PROFESSIONAL is the only audio-cassette program of its kind today. Written by Bill Brooks, it is a 6 cassette, 12 session audio program with a 43 page workbook and complete planning system devoted solely to the sales professional. Available through The Brooks Group, 1903 Ashwood Court, Suite C, Greensboro, NC 27455, 1-800-633-7762.

3. TOUGH-MINDED TIME MANAGEMENT. 6 Audio-Cassettes by Dan Kennedy feature: how to defend yourself against the powerful negative, interfering forces that steal your productivity; how to relate time to money; how to build your own steel curtain defense; how to control the flow of the day; how to delegate and get it done right. $49.95. 1-800-223-7180.

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Articles from 'Kennedy On Money/Business Success'

The following pages are from a book published in 1985. Reprinted here, the items related to time management, goal-setting and personal productivity.

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MAKING THE GOAL-SETTING PROCESS WORK

There are eight basic steps to the process of effective goal-setting:

1. **WHAT** — define, as specifically as possible, exactly what it is that you want to get or accomplish. Write it down.

2. **WHY** — define, in as much detail as possible, *all* of the benefits you, and others, will receive from the achievement of the goal.

   One of the most difficult success concepts for many people to grasp is that the *why-to* of a goal is much more important than the *how-to*. If the *why-to* is strong enough, the *how-to* develops. If the *why-to* is weak, no amount of *how-to* knowledge will get the job done.

   Jim Rohn says that the only reason more people don't become millionaires is because they simply don't have enough reasons to.

   I agree, and I think the same idea applies to all goals; the main reason most people fail to achieve their goals is that they lack enough motivating reasons to. When the temptation to goof off, when an obstacle or setback crops up, the motivation to achieve is insufficient to stay on track.

3. **WHEN** — a goal without a deadline and timetable is *not* a goal.

4. **PRICE** — what will it take and what are you prepared to give up to get the goal? If it doesn't have a price tag, it's probably not worth much. I prefer to analyze and mentally prepare for the price to be paid at the same time I set the goal. Will I have to get up an hour earlier every day...? put $10,000.00 at risk..?...what must I be mentally, physically, financially, and otherwise prepared for, to reach the goal?

5. **OBSTACLES** — if there weren't any obstacles between you and your goal, you'd already have it! Do your best to build a list of all the obstacles that now exist and that you may encounter on the way to the goal. Getting the obstacles down on paper is the first step in bringing the how-to steps together.

6. **HOW** — every goal needs a plan of action; the 1 - 2 - 3 steps you intend to follow. In some situations, this plan can be put together almost immediately; in others, it may evolve gradually, over a period of time, "on the run" so to speak.

'. **WHO CAN HELP?** Who said "no man is an island?" Most goals *do* require some co-operation or involvement of other people. Ask yourself: Who do you need assistance from, how can you obtain their co-operation?

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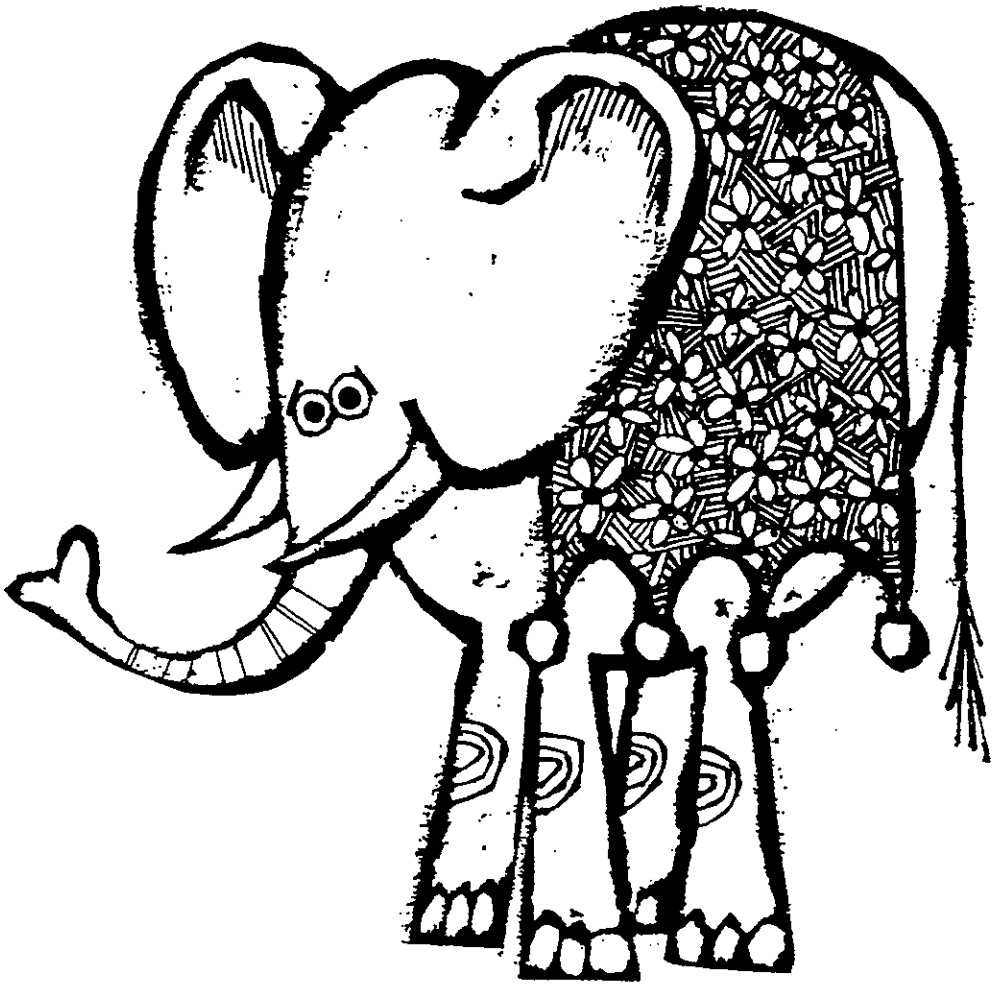
ı. **MEASUREMENT SYSTEM** — Most cliches become oft-repeated cliches because there's so much truth to them. A common cliche in self-improvement is that the way to eat an elephant is one bite at a time. The most effective approach to goal-setting is to work backwards from the ultimate goal and its deadline date, developing a series of smaller, stepladder goals and deadlines...monthly, weekly, even daily benchmarks to measure your progress against. The more bite-size goals you link together, the better.

have used this process literally hundreds of times during the past several 'ears, for personal goals and as a "management by objectives tool" in my ›usiness. Here's my batting average: about 55% completion on schedule, 5% completed late; 70% total. When you combine this process with the right ıttitudes and hard work, you can expect similar or better results.



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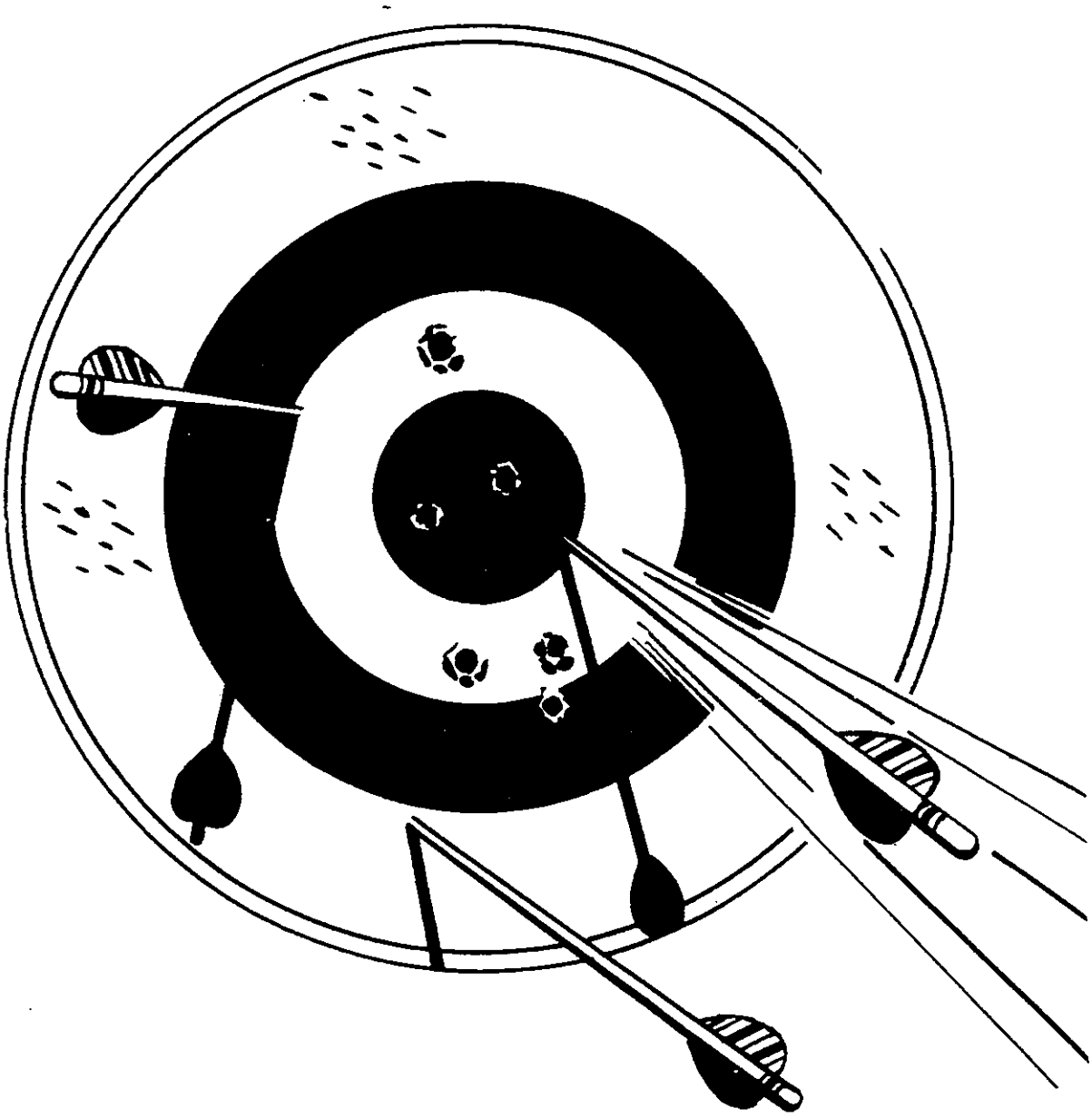
WHAT DO YOU WANT?

In his book, *Ogilvy On Advertising,* the man who built one of the world's largest and most successful advertising agencies stated his beautifully simple approach to getting clients: "I started by making a list of the clients I most wanted."

I often wondered why more sales professionals in various fields, why small business owners, why even people in my field — speaking and consulting — don't take the same approach. Why not go after the most desireable customers or clients, instead of taking whatever comes?



I Challenge You to a Goal

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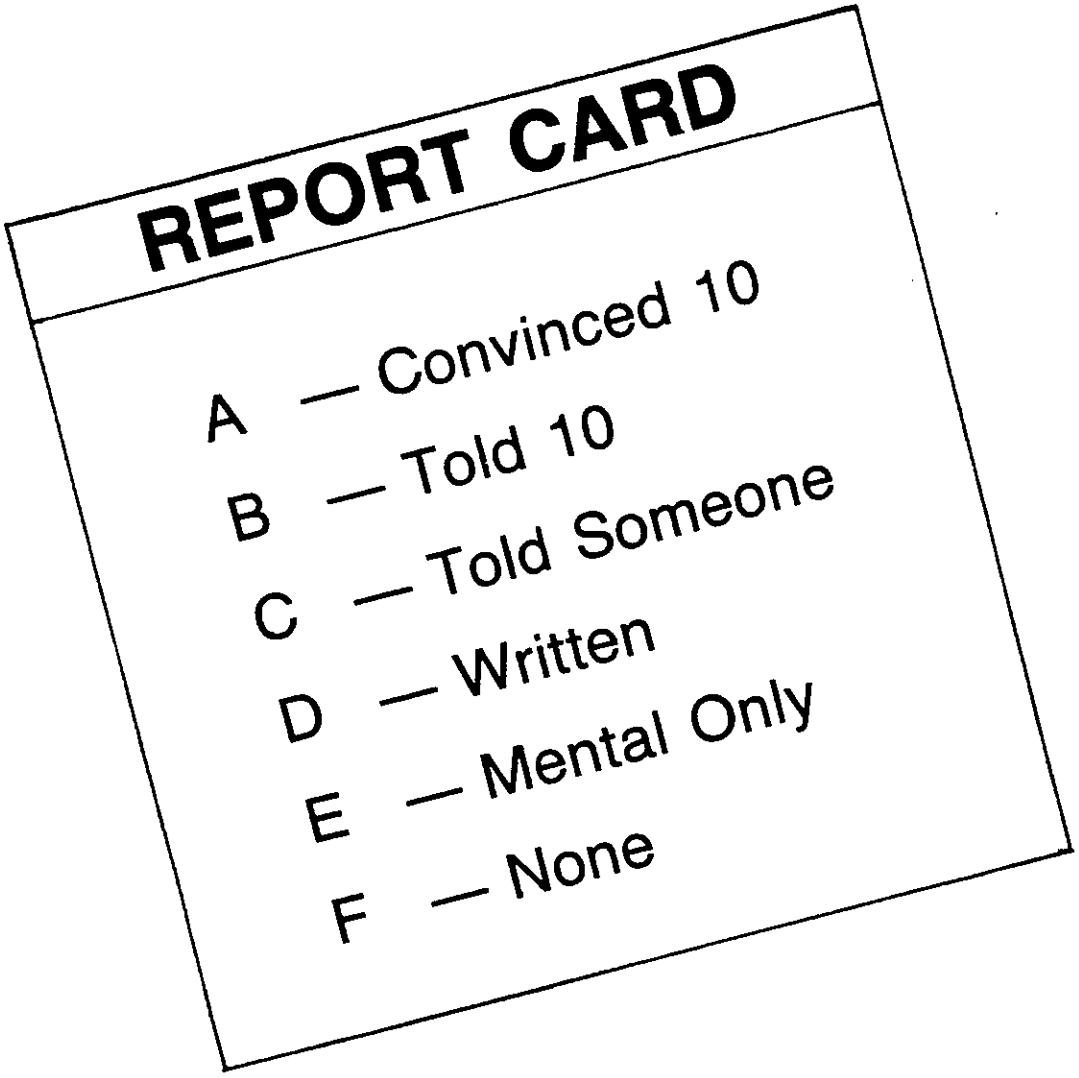

TALKING ABOUT GOALS

Most people fail the Goal Test miserably; most either have no formal goals or, if they claim they do, only have them in their own minds. Goals simply **must** be written down to be real.

The next step, which very few people dare to take, is to tell someone else about their goals. Do you dare to put yourself on the spot? Most people don't.

Of course there **is** significant, inherent danger in talking about your goals to the wrong people.

Your challenge is to find people like yourself, with equally ambitious goals, likely to be encouraging and supportive, to reveal yourself to.

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Massaging Your Goals

In my opinion, the most profound thing Earl Nightingale ever said is that most people have little difficulty in achieving their goals; they do that alright. The problem is in setting them.

It does seem — strangely to me — that Step One of the Eight Steps of THE GOAL-SETTING PROCESS *is* the toughest.

Then, those who do finally write down a few goals tend to jot them down, bury them someplace, and forget about them. Believe me, if the process of *achieving* goals was that quick, easy and magical, everybody'd be a lot further along!

The super-achievers I know massage their goals constantly.

Personally, I use three goal-related tools to keep working with them constantly:

1. **A MASTER GOAL BOOK.** Mine is a giant three-ring notebook with several hundred pages of notes, forms, charts and pictures, divided into sections — one for each project I've got going. The Book is a place to accumulate data and ideas, to record progress, and to work at ever-better crystallization of the goals. Yes, I drag it to and from my offices and use it during the day, almost everyday, even though it *is* awkward. On the average, I spend about three to four hours a week working in this book, massaging my goals.

2. **A TIME MANAGEMENT SYSTEM THAT'S GOAL-RELATED.** Mine is one that I invented, with Larry Dolan, a time management consultant from Denver, called *TEST: Time Effectiveness Success Training.* This System ties the normal, necessary functions of a good appointment book together with monthly, weekly and daily goals, affirmations and a color-coded system for positive psychological feedback.

3. **A STORYBOARD.** One entire wall of each of my two offices is corked and — to the uninformed observer — covered with a confusing maze of multi-colored, different-sized cards tacked to the cork. Actually, the cards are in vertical columns, by objective or project, one task to a card, controlling what I'm working on and what I've delegated to others.

You've got to find ways that work for you, to keep massaging your goals.

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The Steps Beyond Goal-Setting

True high achievers not only set lots of goals and work on them constantly; they actually live *a 100% goal-oriented lifestyle.*

It's difficult to explain this in anything less than several hours of seminar time, but here are the highlights:

1. Have goals for everything, and turn everything into a goal.

2. Pace yourself against lots of short-fuse goals.

   One of the hardest, toughest, driving businessmen I've ever met is the president of a large, successful chain of weight loss centers. In his centers, he has half-day *and* daily sales quotas for each staff member. And they play by baseball rules: miss three quotas and you're out.

   This is even a little brutal for my taste, however the concept *is* sound.

3. Identify daily goals that need to be accomplished repetitively, in order to hit your bigger goals.

   The DAILY ACTIVITY CHART that I invented (on next page) is a deceptively simple, extraordinarily effective Form that allows you to convert every routine but productive task you need to complete each day into what my associate, Joel Beck, calls "small victories."

   This Chart (A) keeps you honest, so you can't kid yourself about how hard you're working; (B) builds consistency in your behavior, which is an important key to success; and (C) gives you lots of self-esteem-building positive strokes for being a "consistent completer."

PROGRESS MEASUREMENT CHART OF _____

FUNCTION OF SUCCESSFULLY BUILDING MY BUSINESS	DAY 1	2	3	4	5	6	7

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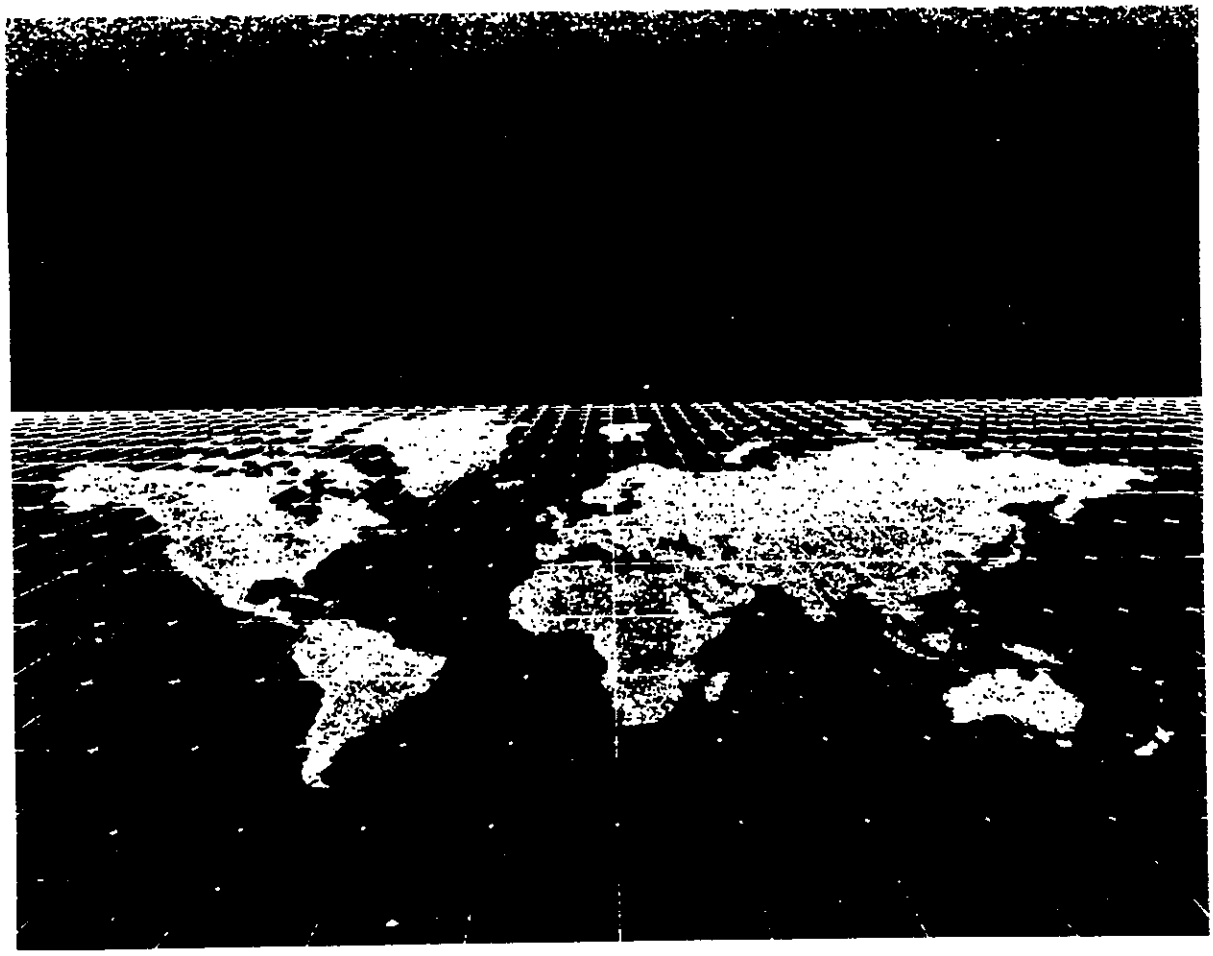
The Next Horizon

In Arnold Palmer's home there is a large, round table in which he has embedded all the medallions from all the golf tournaments he has won. *Each time he puts another medallion into the tabletop, he also routs out the hole for the next medallion.*

The attitude this gesture exemplifies reveals a lot about Palmer's success in golf and in business.

High performance people have a strong sense of dissatisfaction with their own accomplishments. They are looking ahead for the next horizon even as they are reaching the one before it.



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WHAT HAPPENS WHEN YOU MISS A GOAL?

Use your imagination to return to when you were a toddler, just learning to walk. Imagine your father standing just several feet away from you, holding his hands out to you — "Come to daddy," he encourages. You take a tiny, shaky step...another one...then you stumble and fall.

Your father throws you roughly back into your playpen. "You clumsy idiot," he screams, "you just blew your one and only chance to learn to walk!"

Ridiculous, isn't it?

Then don't take that attitude with yourself. Missing goals is an unavoidable, inevitable part of learning how to hit more of your goals. The way to learn to better your batting average is to swing at more balls.

So, the first answer to "What do you do when you miss a goal" is: don't stop setting goals. Keep on.

A second answer is to celebrate a little, based on how close you came. Any achievement is worth celebrating. If you fell short, you should still be better off than you would have been without pursuing the goal at all — and that's good! So, don't beat on yourself too much for missing; celebrate your progress.

A third answer is a real "success secret" I've developed, thanks to the influence of my friend, James Tolleson. This "secret" defies logic, and is the exact opposite of the way most people respond to missing a goal. But, this secret works! Here it is: *don't* re-set the same goal. *Don't* back off to a less ambitious goal. Instead, commit to a similar but even more ambitious goal with a new deadline.

By moving on to a bigger and better version of the missed goal, you haven't failed. And, in my experience, people hit the upgraded goals more often than not.

EFFECTIVE DELEGATION

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In order to be able to manage your time to get the things done that are important to you, you must first preserve some time to manage...by getting your team-members to get the things done that should be important to them.

This requires you to pass on responsibility to others in such a way that they understand; accept; and are motivated to complete the work. This is the toughest part of management for most people. Very few people do it well. And there are a number of factors that influence the relationship between a manager and a given employee that will affect the outcome of delegated work, including personality styles, the overall work environment, etc., which can't be covered in a short discussion. However, there are two certainties about delegating work:

1. The effort will fail if the individual lacks a full understanding of what is to be done.
2. The effort will fail if a procedure is not in place and understood for checking the work.

Here, then, are 7 questions to ask yourself to insure that the individual understands the assignment and that its completion will be checked:

1. What is to be done?
2. Why does it need to be done?
3. Who is to do it?
4. When is it to be done by?
5. When is the "doer" to report on progress?
6. How is the "doer" to report?
7. What will constitute and verify successful completion...what are the desired results?

The Cluttered Desk Controversy

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I know some executives with a clean desk fetish. No matter when you enter their office, you'll find a pristinely clean, polished desktop, and a showroom-neat office. This is supposed to convey that the resident manager is super-organized, efficient and in control. The reality is that he probably isn't doing much of anything.

Harold Geneen, of ITT-fame, writes, in his book "Managing", "If you are on the firing line with the leadership of several projects, you are going to have eighty-nine things on your desk, ten others on the floor beside you, and eight others on the credenza behind you."

That pretty much describes my office.

However, I also devoutly believe that excessive clutter and disorganization is a tremendous energy and productivity drain.

So, a balance must be struck between the Oscar-Felix extremes. Here are some of the methods I use to strive for that balance:

1. Move paperwork that can be delegated off your desk first thing in the morning. I usually start work an hour earlier than our staff, and use that hour to move things from my desk to theirs.

2. Use a "tickler file." I've found this to be an indispensable management tool. I have 93 file-folders: 1-31 red; 1-31 blue; 1-31 white. Red is the current month, blue the next month, white the month after that. All items requiring future actions can be filed in the appropriate folder, to automatically pop up when the time to act on them arrives. Example: literature arrives in the mail about a conference I may want to attend two months from now, but that I'm not prepared to decide on now. I file it in the folder for the first day of the next month, and forget about it.

3. When in doubt, throw it out! If there's doubt about the need to keep something, toss it. Odds are, it's not going to be important.

4. Don't add to the paper mill. I often think that our office operations alone may be resonsible for wiping out whole forests each month. I do my best not to make it worse. If a phone call will do, no letter memos are generated.

5. Clean files every month.

6. Recognize that assorted paperwork is going to accumulate in spite of your

best efforts, and plan accordingly. Each month, when I plan my schedule, I insert a half-day a couple times during the month, to deal with the accumulated work.

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7. Have adequate space for "piles" of work, so it doesn't accumulate on your desk. Shelves, closets, file space, and a credenza are necessary allies in the battle to keep a desk useable.

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On this side of this cassette we'll be talking about some tools of creative thinking.

In each of my offices I have and use a tool sometimes called a storyboard...or a "displayed thinking board." Those who know it as a Storyboard adopted the idea from Walt Disney and the Disney companies. Walt had sliding corkboard wall panels mounted on tracks, one behind the other, in his offices...creating what he called an 'infinite wall.' This evolved from the tacking of animation drawings up on walls, in order, to create a cartoon. If you ever have an opportunity to visit a cartoon studio and see how animated features come together you'll instantly appreciate the necessity of infinite walls. (Just to have one cartoon character make one gesture may require twenty or thirty separate drawings.)

To give credit where credit is due, this use of the infinite wall/storyboard as a creativity and planning tool has moved from the Disney environment to hundreds of other companies principally through the teaching and consulting work of Mr. Michael Vance. Mike Vance worked closely with Walt Disney for a number of years, and was integrally involved in the planning and development of Walt Disney World in Orlando. Today, Mike consults with hotel chains and many other types of businesses on creativity and management. His services aren't cheap. Attending a Vance Seminar can cost as much as two thousand dollars per person.

FOR INFORMATION ABOUT MR. VANCE'S EDUCATIONAL MATERIALS AND SEMINARS, WRITE:

Intellectual Equities,Inc.
16600 Sprague Road,Suite 120
Cleveland,Ohio 44130

I've since re-arranged and modified the basics I learned from studying Mike Vance into the systems I use today, in my offices, for my businesses, that we're looking at in this Course Module. It's important to understand that the 'mechanics' of use -- his, mine, or someone else's -- are arbitrary. They serve our purposes but might not necessarily serve yours equally well. The concepts, though, are universal. Once you understand the concepts, you can play with the mechanics to arrive at personal applications that work best for you.

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The first basic concept behind use of the Storyboard is to reduce mental and physical clutter and confusion.

Essential ideas and information are removed from drawers, file folders, pockets, attache cases,etc....where they hide, get lost, and are often forgotten. Ideas are removed from your memory, gathered up from paper scraps...and displayed in an organized manner, in this case - on the wall.

This injection of organization to your thinking is, in itself, very beneficial.

The second basic concept behind displayed thinking is simply better, clearer thinking. By accomplishing just that, it's earning its space!

The third basic concept is flexibility. This is not supposed to be a static display. No dust should every gather on your Storyboard! The display is constantly changing. You will be adding, subtracting and re-arranging the items on your Storyboard frequently.

STORYBOARD "PARTS"

1. The corkboard wall or a bulletin board or boards. (Allow PLENTY of space!)
2. 3x5" Cards, possibly varied sizes of cards
3. Different colored cards
4. Push-Pins
5. Felt Tip Markers (different colors)

The fourth basic concept behind displayed thinking is the visualization of goals and objectives. At other times, in other materials, we've discussed the many benefits of visualizing your goals; this tool turns that into a real process.

There are a number of uses of displayed thinking. I'm going to describe the ways that I commonly use it, however you will undoubtedly discover many other uses particularly appropriate to your business or other activities.

One use is as a giant TO-DO CHECKLIST. One portion of the board is divided into DO - DOING - DELEGATED - DONE. The short-term tasks are tacked to the board; one item per card; and then moved through the sections as they are completed. This is somewhat similar to Production Control Boards used in factories.

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Some people also call this a BRIEFING BOARD or a COMMUNICATION BOARD, because it can answer questions for others about the status of a project or task.

Another use is to plan a particularly complex project. Let's say that you're putting together a new direct-mail campaign to your customers, as an example. On the Board, you might have several sections to collect and organize information and ideas. For example, you might have a Historical Section, where notes about results, problems and errors of past direct-mail efforts are gathered. There'll be an Idea Section, where words, phrases, drawings and other components of the campaign are collected as they're thought of. Also, a FINANCIAL SECTION where suppliers' bids and other cost data is collected. And a FLOW CHART where the steps, from conception to actual mailing are shown and deadlines attached to them.

In my office at 8350 N. 7th Street, I have a section of a Board for each business enterprise that I manage. In each section, for each business, I can collect ideas; display charts and schedules; prioritize steps of projects -- completely organize my thinking.

The tools of displayed thinking are ordinary, inexpensive items. A wall covered with corkboard; various sizes of cards; markers; push pins; and some string or tape, if you want to divide the Board into Sections. I like to carry a supply of the cards with me at all times, so that I can jot down ideas or information in a format ready for transfer to the Board the next time I'm in my office.

We recently had some cards printed and a little portfolio designed for this purpose. And there are other commercially available "systems" designed along these lines. A company called EXECU-SCAN has a whole line of portfolios with slots and pockets that take little cards -- sort of like travelling mini-storyboards. After you've worked with displayed thinking in your office or home for a little while, you'll also want to get a "travelling storyboard".

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Mike Vance suggests the development of an entire "creative thinking room" in your office or home, with storyboard walls and other tools of creativity. I'm now planning such a room in my home.

I can assure you that the use of displayed thinking will stimulate and enhance your creativity.

There is no doubt that certain aspects of creative talent have relationships with inherited characteristics. However, many people erroneously believe that all creativity is "in the genes." However, most of the most creative people in business argue that creativity can be learned, as a collection of skills and processes.

Another popular myth is that creative people are disorganized...even that disorganization is a badge of the creative individual. Nonsense. Creativity is a process of thinking, and no type of thinking can be enhanced by confusion. People who claim that it is necessary to be disorganized to be creative are lying to themselves and to you.

I used to be in the advertising business, and I find that the public perception of advertising agencies is as dens of weirdly creative wizards, sitting around playing with ideas in free-form style. Well, some of that does go on. But the ad agency business itself is a rigidly organized and efficient business operation, and its leaders utilize excellent organizational skills and procedures. They have to. They're in a dynamically competitive business. They're managing a complex collection of projects and people, usually under extreme pressure.

One of the highest-paid, most creative direct-mail copywriters in the business today laughs at most people's ideas about creativity. He says they think he goes up to the top of a mountain somewhere and gets his ideas from communing with the cosmos. He says he sits down at the typewriter and grinds them out, painfully, with good old hard work.

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I can tell you from personal experience that creativity is at least equal parts hard work and flashes of insight and intuition. Someone -- Einstein, Edison, I'm not sure -- defined "genius" as 1% inspiration and 99% perspiration.

I learned to write what I call "million dollar sales letters"....direct-response advertising copy that works successfully for the promotion of a diverse variety of products and services. I have no formal education in that specialty. I didn't take any advertising or marketing courses in college. As a matter of fact, I never went to college. I taught myself, through research, study, observation, practice, hard work, and even unsuccessful experience. Most people view this as an extremely "creative" process, and there is some creativity involved. There are even flashes of insight and intuition. But all that has been manufactured through a process virtually anyone could duplicate.

My ability to deal with and almost always solve business and financial problems has been a mainstay of my personal career as well as my consulting activities. This, too, has been learned from a sequence of study, research, observation, deliberate mental discipline and experience that virtually anyone could duplicate. Out of that comes the ability to quickly identify creative solutions to difficult problems.

You see, the main reason why more people aren't more creative is that they believe creativity is something much more magical and mystical than it is, and believe that certain people have it and certain people don't. The truth is that certain people choose to develop it; others choose not to develop it.

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Most types of practical, useful creativity combine knowledge; the organization of knowledge; and the experimental re-arrangement of knowledge. Anyone can learn to do that.

First, anyone can go collect the knowledge needed for a particular purpose.

Our public libraries are woefully underused. Right there, housed and carefully organized in your public library, is a vast assortment of useful knowledge, accessible to you free of charge.

People who claim they don't know how to do a necessary thing...who seek sympathy because "no one ever taught them"...have no credibility with me. I've had people tell me they can't balance a checkbook; cook; write good business letters...and on and on...because no one ever taught them. But, if pressed, these same people always have to admit that they have not taken the initiative to teach themselves these things, either. You'll be hard-pressed to name a skill useful in daily living or in business that you cannot learn from information readily available at the public library, at no cost. Beyond that, of course, we know that commercially available books, cassettes, home study courses, seminars and classes also offer training on every conceivable subject today. As a result, anyone who genuinely wants and needs a certain type of knowledge can find it, collect it and learn it.

And, incidentally, **you should make it a habit to systematically acquire additional information and knowledge about those subjects most relevant to your goals.**

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I suggest reading at least a book a week, plus a number of newsletters and magazines....daily listening to cassettes...frequently attending seminars... and building files of information and reference material to assist you now and in the future. In the corporate world, this is called RESEARCH & DEVELOPMENT, and every successful firm has an on-going, active, well-funded R&D program. **What do you know this week that you didn't know last week about your job, work or business...your industry or profession...the trends that affect that industry or profession? What do you know this week that you didn't know last week about getting along with people? What do you know this week that you didn't know last week about the activities you plan to engage in in the future?**

The collection of new, increased knowledge is critically important to the person seeking enhanced creativity. However, it's also very important to remember that the collection of knowledge itself is only a means to an end, not the end. The people who've told you that knowledge is power lied. It is not. Dormant knowledge is arguably no better than no knowledge at all. The often-used illustration of this is that the person who can read but does not read is no better off than the illiterate who cannot read.

Even in a negative way, knowledge alone is not power. While living and ensconced at the FBI, J. Edgar Hoover was considered by many to be the most powerful man in Washington --- even able to treat the President of the United States with little respect. Many people attribute Hoover's awesome power to his secret, private files containing "dirt" about hundreds, possibly thousands of influential political and business leaders. If that much is true, then this is also true: Hoover's power did not come from his mere possession of those files. It came from his use of those files.

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It's claimed by certain insiders who should know that Hoover would visit each newly elected United States President and lay before him his own file, as a graphic demonstration of who was really in the driver's seat. It was this use of the files that gave Hoover his power over Presidents.

Similarly, but in more positive scenarios, the mere possession of knowledge does not carry with it much power. The use of knowledge does. And, the effective use of knowledge carries with it almost unlimited power.

If collection of knowledge, then, is a first step; organization of knowledge; that is, the preparation of knowledge for use must be the second step. Disorganized information is not very useful. When you have to struggle to pull information together before you can use it, you quickly become distracted, possibly even irritated, and your capacity to use the information is diminished.

Again, the "creative people" understand this point, and are usually well-organized, although the general public may not see them as such.

One of America's funniest professional speakers is Dr. Charles Jarvis of San Marcos, Texas. He successfully does the most difficult comedic task: uses only clean humor. And, as opposed to the typical stand-up comedian's 15 to 30-minute bits, Dr. Jarvis can go for 90 minutes to even several hours, presenting humorous and thought-provoking material...and keeping the audience in laughter. People who see this marvel at it. Unseen by them, of course, is Dr. Jarvis' massive, comprehensively organized, cross-indexed reference library of humorous material. To him, being funny is serious business.

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Collection. Organization. Then, third, the experimental re-organization of the collected and organized knowledge.

Everyone knows how to do this, and has done it. For example, think for a minute about the furnishing or re-furnishing of a room in your house. Decorators do it one way, but how do most people do it? They assemble the furniture and accessories they have to use in the room. Then they play with the possibilities. What if...we moved the couch over against that wall....angled it instead of putting it against the wall...what if, what if, what if. This same process can be used with pieces of information and knowledge as with pieces of furniture.

THE STORYBOARD that we've discussed on this cassette is a device for exactly that kind of experimentation.

When you understand the simplicity, logic, and sequential thinking that makes up creativity, you automatically become a more creative individual.

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FOR YOUR ADDITIONAL CONSIDERATION

Napoleon Hill wrote: "anything the mind can conceive and believe, it can achieve." CONCEIVE is roughly the same as CREATE. So, creative thinking is the first and foremost key for entry into Hill's formula.

Consider something that most people can't conceive of; maybe that you can't conceive of. Making a million dollars in three years. Buying a business of your own with no money down. Becoming a great novelist. Etc. Then think of how you can apply the steps just disccused to being able to conceive that inconceivable.

1) Make a list of all the different categories of knowledge you might collect. Develop an action plan for collecting it.

2) Organize the knowledge you collect for easy, convenient, logical access.

3) Experiment with the knowledge, trying to arrange pieces of information into a sequence and structure you can use, that makes the idea believable.

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Misc.

Articles & Notes

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IN PRAISE OF CLUTTERED DESKS

A clean desk in the corner office usually means that someone else is running the business, argues the former head of ITT. There can be method in what may look like madness: details are attended to, new ideas surface, and the boss keeps his grip. ■ *by Harold S. Geneen*

THERE ARE, arbitrarily speaking, two kinds of business executives: one has a clean desk, the other a cluttered one. It's been my impression through the years that when I come upon a man who has a gleaming, empty, clean desktop, I am dealing with a fellow who is so far removed from the realities of his business that someone else is running it for him.

Many disagree with me, I know. They say that a clean desk indicates an executive who has an organized mind. All his papers are filed in their proper places, and a buzz to his secretary will fetch the one he wants. His day is organized in specific segments so that at 10 A.M. he takes up one subject, at 10:30 another. I say hogwash.

It is practically impossible for a top manager, or even a middle manager, to be doing the work that he should be doing and at the same time have a clean desk. In even one project of moderate size, there are so many angles to be considered simultaneously that they cannot be rigidly relegated to a designated time in the day. The telephone rings, an important letter arrives, an emergency arises. An executive, normally handling a great deal more than one project at a time, can retain only so much information in his head. He has to reach for that report on his desk.

If you are on the firing line with the leadership of several projects, you are going to have 89 things on your desk, ten others on the floor beside you, and eight others on the credenza behind you. When the telephone rings or

ILLUSTRATIONS BY MARC ROSENTHAL

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when you have to rush off to a meeting, you want to grab the information you need right then. You don't want to have to stop and describe to your secretary the reports or memorandums you need. Your own filing system is right on top of your desk: acquisitions are at the far right corner, budget figures in the near left corner, compensation and personnel recommendations to the right of the budget figures, and so on. It is not scientific, but it works.

I kept my working files in my own office, the important ones on top of the desk, some on the floor, some behind me, some in my oversize attaché cases. I knew where everything was because I put it there. At the end of each day, I put my files back in the 15 or 20 attaché cases I kept on the windowsills and side tables of the office. On a trip, I took three or four of the cases with me. I had "containerized" my office. I could and did take it with me everywhere I went.

My filing system was perhaps a bit unusual. When I finished with a report or a set of papers, I turned that file over to my secretary. She kept it for three months. Then, automatically, she threw it away. I didn't need anything more than 90 days old—

In 17 years as chief executive of ITT, Harold Geneen became widely known as the hardest of hard-nosed executives. FORTUNE's coverage of ITT during the Geneen years found fault with his management more than once but never underestimated the man or the power of his ideas. In the forthcoming book Managing, *written with Alvin Moscow, Geneen reflects on what he learned about running a business. This article, the last of a series, is adapted from the book.*

business to me is an ever-changing, living process.

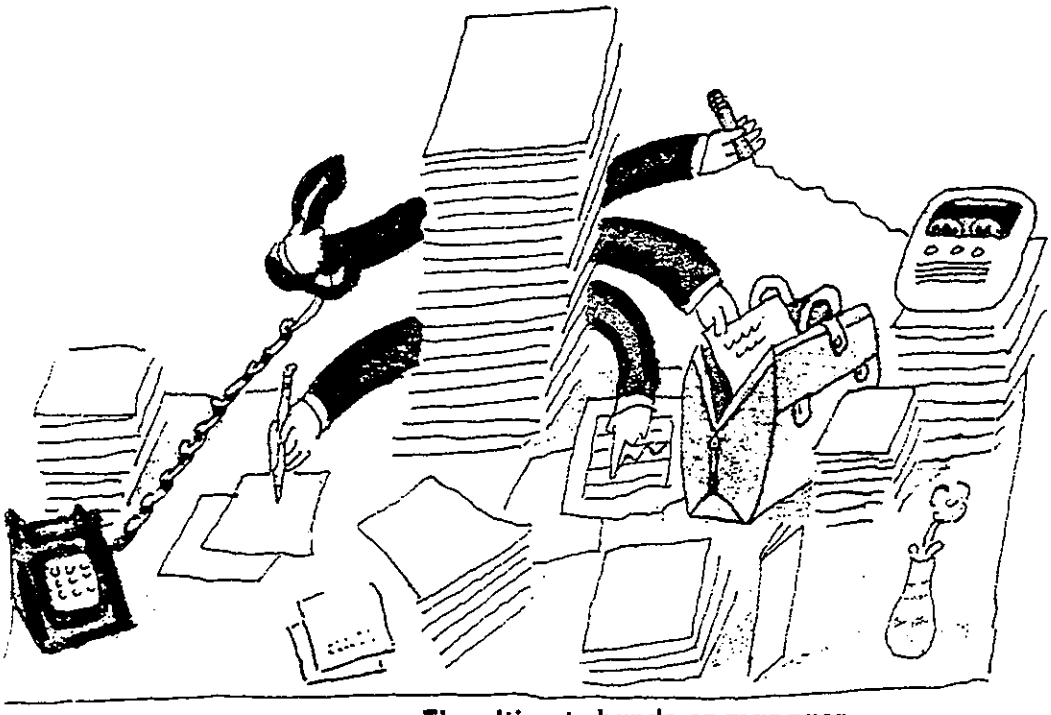
My desk was cluttered because I immersed myself in the company's business. I did myself what most executives delegate to others: I dictated my own letters and wrote or at least outlined the speeches I would make, rather than have a professional do them. My letters and speeches were not as polished as they might have been otherwise, but they conveyed what I wanted to say and in my own voice. My secretary did not pass on which incoming telephone calls would reach me. I was informed by intercom or with a note of every call. I decided which calls were urgent, important, or not important. Figuratively at least, my office door was open to anyone in the company who thought he had a need to see me. He or she might have to wait until I had a free moment, but my attitude was that I was willing to listen with an open mind to whatever someone had to say.

The clean-desk executive undoubtedly will think all of the above constitutes a terrible waste of valuable executive time. But in my view, the man who delegates responsibilities without knowing the intimate details of what is involved runs the enormous risk of rendering himself superfluous. He may become what I call a three-by-five-card executive. His people give him decision alternatives on a three-by-five index card and he checks off one of the choices. The people in the company know who is really making the decisions. They know whose recommendations are always adopted and whose aren't.

THE REAL DANGER in turning over responsibility and authority for a job without knowing the details is that the manager who receives the assignment might fail. If that happens, the chief executive does not know enough to rescue the project. Behind the façade of a lofty title and a huge office, the executive is incompetent.

And he is no leader. The first obligation of any chief executive is to set the goals for his company. It is his responsibility to point his people in the direction of the goal posts and tell them how to get there. To do this he has to know the facts. At ITT, I set a competitive and challenging goal: a steady, stable growth of 10% to 15% in earnings per share for each and every year. Together we set out to double our earnings in five years.

I never let up. I talked about growth, I talked about how we were going to achieve it, and I talked about more growth. In the beginning of my tenure at ITT, I spent night after night talking with our management teams about what we were going to do with the company, discussing how we intended to do it. Now it must be understood



The ultimate hands-on manager

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agenda, it should not be brought up. The agenda is timed precisely: we should be at item three at 10:03, on item four at 10:13, on item five at 10:22 . . . adjournment at 11:30.

The attempt to structure a meeting so precisely puts everyone at the meeting in a straitjacket. The man who was about to say something won't even open his mouth because he knows the five or ten minutes allotted to that subject is over. You are going to lose whatever he had to say. How can you select the best gems of thought when all you hear are the first thoughts that happen to come up?

The cluttered-desk executive goes into his committee meeting with an agenda too, but to him the timetable is not nearly as important as what might arise unexpectedly. The most important item of the day could turn up at the end of the time allotted to that subject. It might be worth two hours of discussion, rather than five minutes. Digressions, repetitions, and pontifications should, of course, be squelched unmercifully. But the boss should know, too, when not to cut off a discussion.

Those kinds of meetings will usually run late—for the same reason that the executive's desk is cluttered. It is a question of values. Which is more important: to direct a meeting so that it ends on time or to run a meeting so that you don't kill off imagination or miss any opportunities that flash through the air? In a good meeting there is a momentum that comes from the spontaneous exchange of fresh ideas and produces extraordinary results. That momentum depends on the freedom permitted the participants.

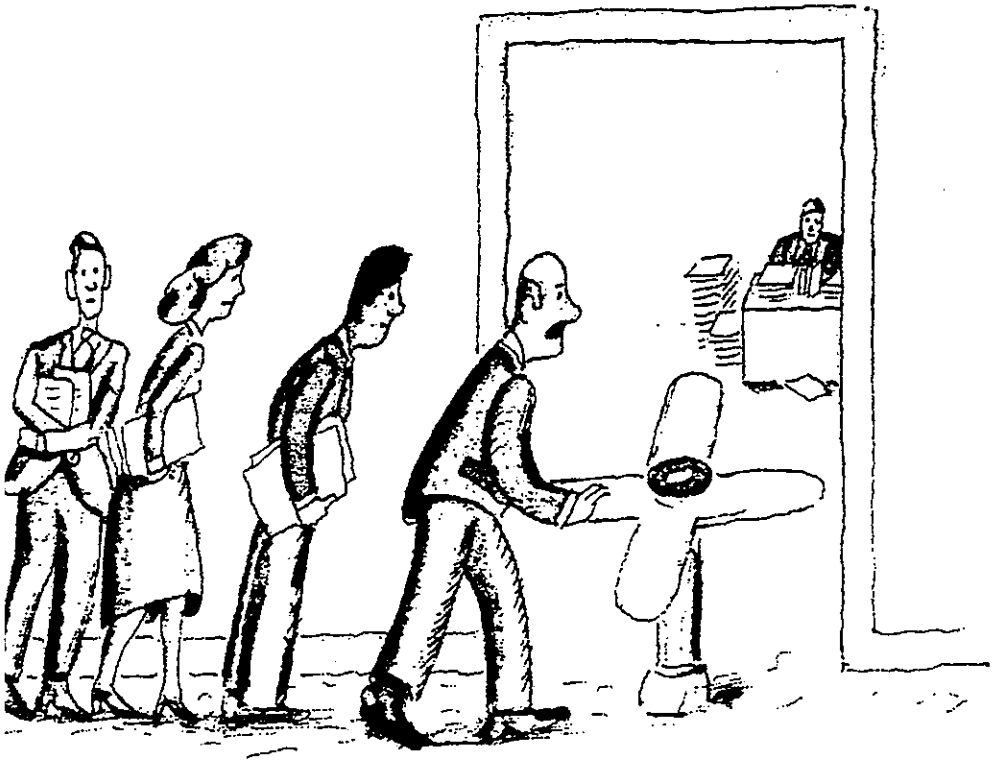
The price you pay for that open, flexible meeting is that you are usually, if not always, running late. That is one of my worst faults. I set up a series of meetings in my office and each one goes on longer than I expect, so by the end of the day I have a line of people waiting to see me. I am aware of the problem. But there is nothing I can do about it, or will do about it, as long as I feel it is more important to get the job done than to keep to a rigid schedule.

As president and then chairman of ITT, I was perceived from the outside as a tough man to work for. I was often portrayed that way in the press. The stereotype of the difficult, ruthless S.O.B. driving his subordinates to early graves in his quest for quarterly profits makes good copy and sells magazines. Actually, the management team that stayed with ITT through the years and took over when I retired thrived on the fast pace and on the growth that we engendered. In recent years since my retirement, I have received many letters from men who said that those early growing years with ITT had been the most thrilling time of their lives.

TO THE DEGREE that business commanders strike fear in the hearts of their management teams, they have turned the American business world into a jungle in which scared people compete *within* a company to survive. In the long run I am certain that this is counterproductive. Frightened people play office politics; they won't come forward, admitting their problems early enough for them to be solved. Capable, independent people leave, not willing to work under those conditions.

As a matter of policy, which was stamped upon the management of all 250 profit centers of ITT, we treated every individual company manager as an individual entrepreneur. We were demanding, but decent. I might criticize what he had done or failed to do, but my attacks were never personal. At meetings large and small, I never demeaned a man's ability or threatened him. Sarcasm or personal attacks were not countenanced at any level. Open communication meant that every man was entitled to speak his piece. I wanted my people to be as imaginative and creative as they could possibly be.

Good ideas are hard to come by, and I always felt that as chief executive it was incumbent upon me to welcome and foster imaginative thinking. The chief executive is the man in the best position to take the risk of allocating money for a seemingly wild idea. Big companies like ITT, with all their resources, can afford to take such risks. Some of our ventures succeeded beyond even our own expectations. That helped build confidence in our ability to reach even further out into the unknown. It also helped that we had at our fingertips all the details of even the riskiest of the company's undertakings. They were right there, in their place, on that cluttered desk. ■



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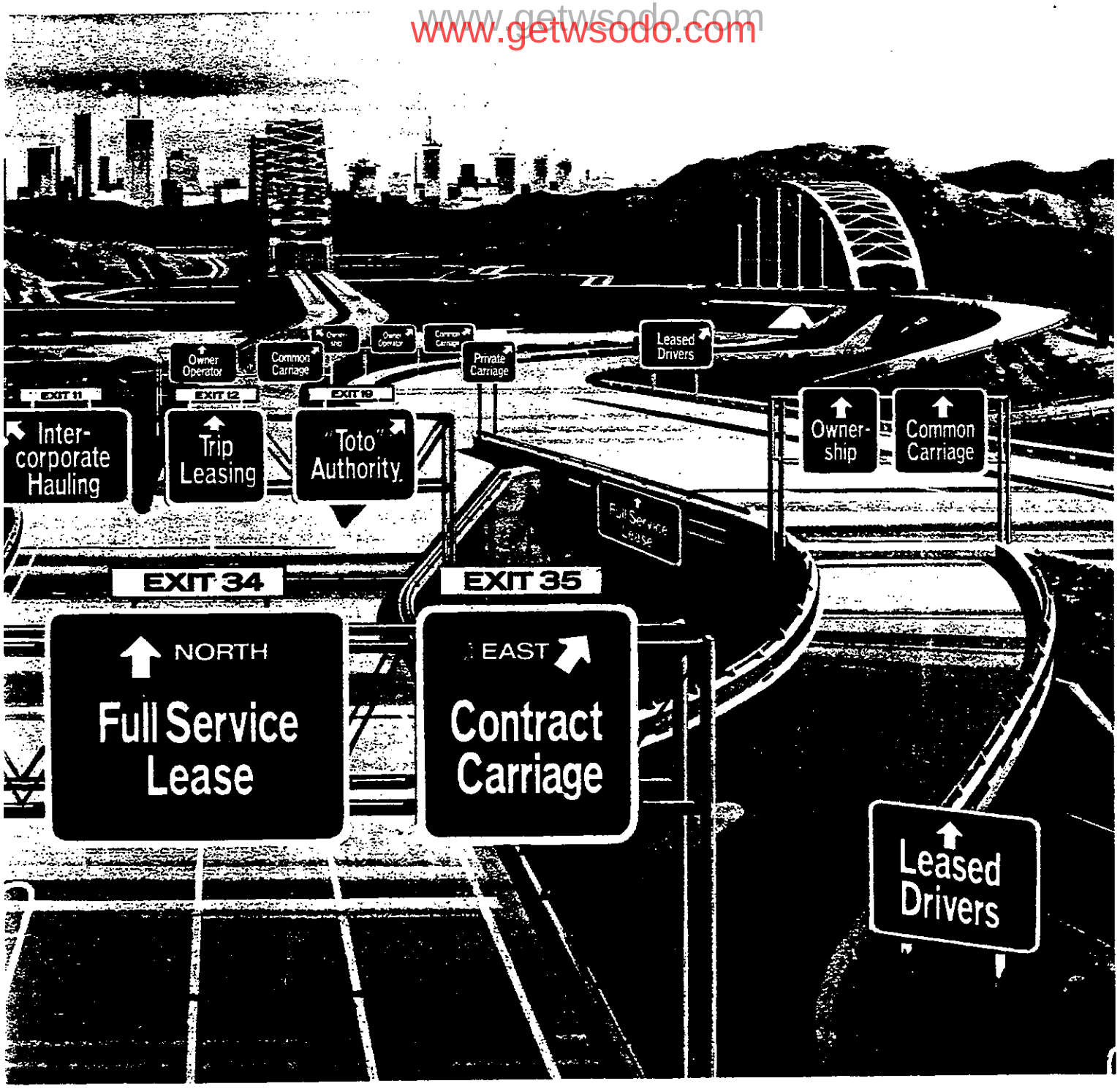

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that we were not ordering these men to increase their earnings by 10% to 15% each year. We were telling them that we were all going to do it together, that the headquarters team, including the chief executive, was there to help them achieve these goals.

A good cluttered-desk executive understands that the company's working environment is vital to success of the enterprise. Climate control is in the hands of the chief executive. To me the most important element in establishing a happy, prosperous atmosphere was an insistence upon open, free, and honest communication up and down the ranks. If you're going to get the accurate, detailed information you need to manage, you must have such communication. That was the reason for our numerous meetings: general managers' meetings, budget review meetings, problem-oriented meetings, ad hoc meetings. We cut through layers of fat in our management ranks by putting all the people in one room so they could talk with one another, face to face, regardless of rank.

There was a clear understanding that we *owed* each other our honest opinions at all times. People could disagree with me or anyone else, and no one would suffer as a consequence. I tried to welcome criticism. Naturally, no one *likes* to be criticized. One's first instinct is to be defensive. But that is the kind of defensiveness managers should try to keep under control.

I always wanted someone to point out where I might be heading for a mistake. Sometimes I was clearly wrong; sometimes the critic was mistaken. Not infrequently it was a little of both. Almost always new facts and new ideas emerged, and our exchange would reveal a better course of action that neither of us had envisioned before.

To ensure open and honest communications, it seemed to me that office politicking could not be tolerated. I announced this in unmistakable terms: If anyone tried to line up other managers to back his pet project in return for a quid pro quo later, or if anyone tried to force a man junior to him to give anything other than his honest opinion, he did so in peril of losing his job. I let it be known that anyone who was importuned for a political favor should report the matter to me privately.

It happened once that I can recall vividly. A vice president came into my office and told me in detail how a senior officer at headquarters had asked him to change his opinion and to back the senior official on one of his pet projects, saying that he would return the favor in time. The vice president, a relatively new man with us, did not know what to do. I thanked him for being honest and told him to put the matter out of his mind, to keep it confidential, and that I would take care of it.

I CALLED THE SENIOR executive into my office. When he reached my desk, I did not ask him to sit down, as I usually did. Instead I told him, "Don't say a word, because if you say one word, you're fired." Then I repeated in detail the story I had been told, without revealing the source—I felt confident he had tried the same trick with other subordinates. "Now that's the story I've learned, and I believe it, because it rings true," I told him, warning him again, "Don't say a word. I don't want an answer. I just want you to know that I know. Also, I am warning you now that if you ever do that again and I hear about it, I am going to fire you, and I am not even going to tell you why. You'll know why. Don't say a word. Just leave, and we'll never talk about this again." He turned on his heel and left, without saying a word.

I would like to be able to report that that man never tried such a thing again and that office politics was wiped out at ITT. But that millennium never arrived. I do believe, however, that office politics was kept to a minimum, and only partly because of the dire consequences I threatened. Office politics spreads most malignantly in stagnant companies. At ITT we were expanding so fast that there was plenty of room for our management people to advance and grow in the company without petty maneuvering.

A clean-desk executive, because of his compulsiveness, might not have taken all this trouble to keep his lines of communication open. He insists that reports be precise, no longer than 1½ or two pages long—no matter how complex the subject matter. He insists upon an exact agenda for his committee meetings. If an item is not on the

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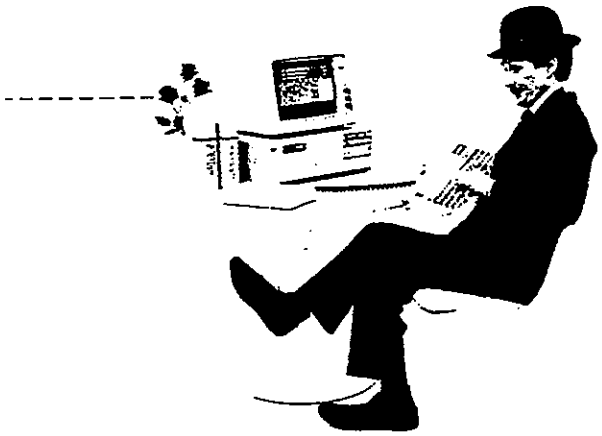
or one for all.



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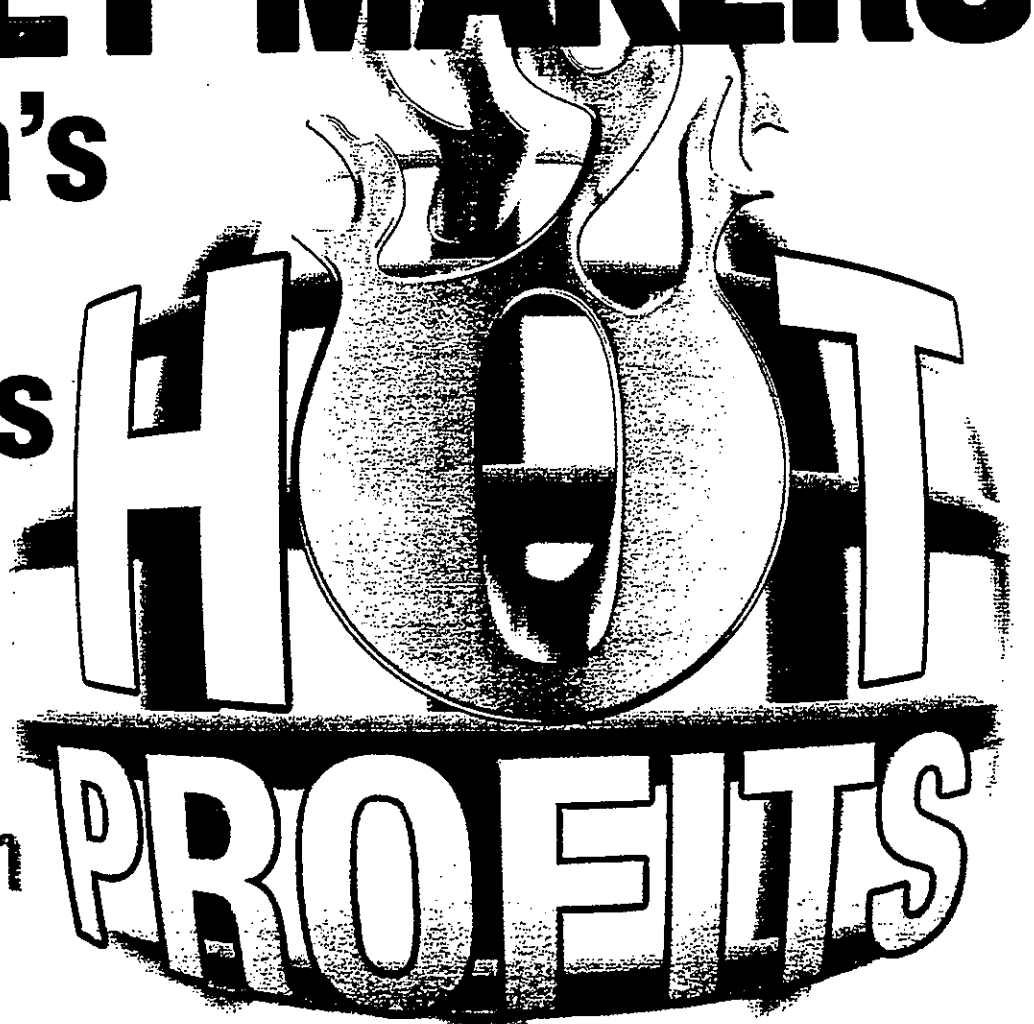

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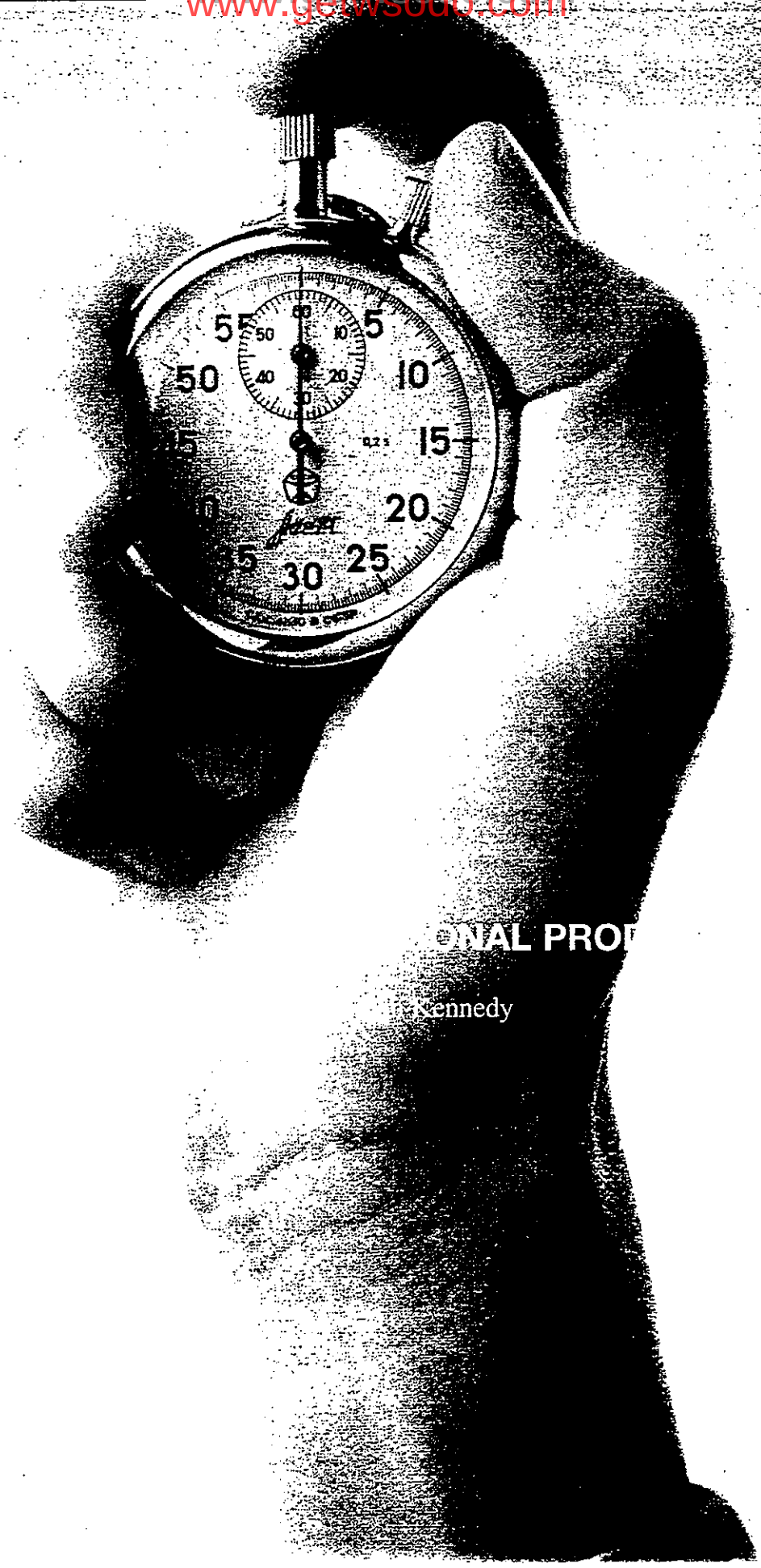

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The multiple demands on a small business owner's and/or manager's time are extraordinary. So I am here to tell you that you need to take extraordinary measures to match those demands. Measures so radical and extreme that others may question your sanity. This is no ordinary time management solution for the deskbound or the person doing just one job.

This is expressly for the wearer of many hats: the inventive, opportunistic entrepreneur ("a person who organizes, operates, and assumes the risk for a business venture") who can't resist piling more and more responsibility onto his or her own shoulders, who has many more great ideas than time and resources to take advantage of them, who runs (not walks) through each day.

I'M YOU, AND THIS IS OUR SOLUTION.

As you have undoubtedly discovered, time is the most precious asset any entrepreneur possesses. Time to solve problems. Time to be more productive. Time to invent, create, think, and plan. Time to gather and assimilate information. Time to develop

sales, marketing, management, and profit breakthroughs. Time to network.

And one of the best ways to give yourself more time is to minimize, or totally eliminate, interruptions. Interruptions can destroy your productivity.

Put a stop to interruptions and you will multiply your productivity. It is that simple!

After reading a study claiming that the average business owner is interrupted once every eight minutes, I had three of my clients who spend all day on their business premises put a watch on it for a day. One reported a better average: once per ten minutes. A second owner, once per six minutes. And the third hollered,

When I used to go to my offices in a place where I was under the same roof with my staff, I found that to be about par—if I let it happen. And, as a big thumb rule, the more employees or associates you've got, the more you get interrupted.

Some years back, I suddenly wound up with a staff of 42 people thrust upon me. For a while, I was interrupted every eight seconds, not every eight minutes. It was embarrassing to ultimately realize that this was all my fault. I permitted, even invited, the interruptions. And I learned to stop them.

There are many reasons for these interruptions, and almost none of them have to do with necessity! If you're going to achieve peak personal productivity in such an environment, here are the five self-defense, time-defense tactics you'll have to use:

FIRST TACTIC: SIMPLE INACCESSIBILITY

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When I was in the office, I was asked lots of questions that I knew the people figured out for themselves when I wasn't there. So my being there, and being accessible, actually diminished their productivity as well as mine.

The answer is not to be there at all. Some entrepreneurs think they have to set a leadership example by being the first person there, to turn on the lights, and the last person to leave, to turn off the lights. I made this mistake, and it is a HUGE mistake. Leadership is not about outworking everybody.

I learned by traveling that my people functioned just as well or better with me as an absentee leader as they did with me onsite. When I was on the road and inaccessible, they handled 80% of everything on their own, most of it satisfactorily, some with excellence, and a little bit unsatisfactorily, but almost always repairable. And they asked me about the other 20% quickly and efficiently, in brief phone conversations or via fax. Since that worked okay when it had to, there's no reason it couldn't work all the time.

SO, I STOPPED GOING IN TO THE OFFICE, PERIOD.

I had a fax at home and at the office, so when I was in town, I stayed at home and worked there, largely uninterrupted. When necessary, I faxed or phoned in; they phoned or faxed me.

Today, I live and work at my Ohio home more than anywhere else. I have only one staff person, and she is in the office—in Phoenix, Arizona. About as far from underfoot as can be.

Almost without exception, we talk by phone once a day, usually for less than 20 minutes. I get truly urgent faxes once a day. And once a week, via FedEx, I get a nicely organized box of other faxes, mail, and a list of questions. She is far better organized in dealing with me than she'd be were I there or more accessible. I am far better organized in dealing with her. I'm certain it equates to at least two hours of productivity saved per day for each of us, and in my world, that's a whole pile of money. A lot more than the weekly FedEx bill.

Dozens of my clients have mimicked these practices, with very good results. In fact, I can name more than 30—some running small businesses like mine with only one or two staff, others running businesses doing as much as $30 million a year—who have offices they seldom visit—from no more than once a week to as seldom as once a month.

For example, I have a friend, a CEO of a $5 million-a-year business, who can't work at home; he has six kids, two dogs, one spouse. So he has a small, $200-a-month office in town, about halfway between his home and his manufacturing facility. It has no phone and no fax. And he spends most of his time there.

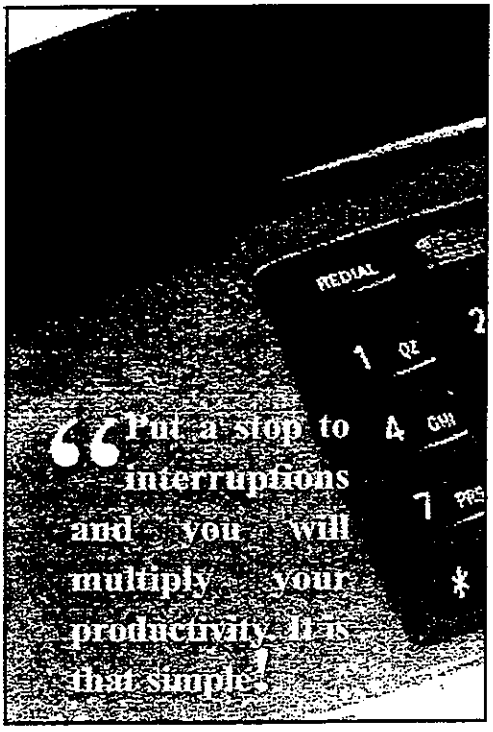
HE AND I AGREE: IF THEY CAN'T FIND YOU, THEY CAN'T INTERRUPT YOU.

If you are going to be in your office with the rest of your staff, then, contrary to my dumb open door management experiment years ago, it is very important that you have a closed door policy. You need some times when everybody knows—because of the closed door, red light, whatever—that you are 100% uninterruptible. And if you want to sit in there and take a nap, you go right ahead. It's none of their damned business.

Next, you've got to get control over the telephone. I think the phone is Peak Productivity Enemy Number 1.

People somehow get conditioned into thinking that they must respond to the phone when it rings, and believe you should, too. At home, on their own time, people will run dripping from the bathtub, jump up from the dinner table, even coitus "interruptus" to answer the phone. Ring. Run. Respond. Nuts.

So, first, let me offer a bit of philosophy: You have absolutely no legal, moral, or



other responsibility to answer the phone or take a call unless you want to. At home, I routinely take the phone off the hook to take a shower, eat a meal, take a nap, watch a favorite TV program, etc. There's nothing—and I mean nothing—happening on earth that can't or won't wait an hour. Or two. You should carry that attitude into your work, too.

Different people need different levels of control over telephone interruptions, but I do not believe anybody ought to be wide open to inbound calls. This is like walking around with a "Kick Me" sign tacked to your back. If you take inbound calls as they come, you are constantly stopping work on a task of known priority in favor of something or someone of unknown priority. You are turning control of your day over to the unknown. And at the end of most days, you'll be worn out, but you won't have gotten to do most of the things you wanted to do.

Personally, I have very rarely encountered an inbound call damaged by a day's delay in response. Most of my important calls are forwarded to me while traveling, and I start trying to return them the next day. A lot of the calls wait three, four, even five days before I take time to return them.

OCCASIONALLY, SOMEBODY'S aggravated—which is his problem, not mine—but I have yet to notice this approach costing me any money. Not a nickel. In fact,

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ironically, in my business (and in many), being somewhat difficult to get to actually helps rather than hinders securing new clients and having those clients appreciate and respect your time and assistance.

Rightly or wrongly, most folks don't put a lot of value on getting to the wise man at the bottom of the mountain.

THE TAKE-WITH-YOU PHONE

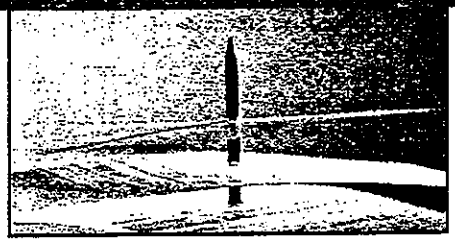
Now, the cell phone—an evil invention if there ever were one. People really feel compelled to answer these things 24/7. It is the ultimate interruption welcome mat, and it has amazing, mysterious powers over its owner.

Increasingly, I am noticing men standing at urinals in public restrooms taking care of business while talking on the phone simultaneously. Look, if you can't even pee in peace, you are not Mr. Super-Important. You are Mr. Super-Stupid.

Personally, I refuse to own or use a cell phone at all. I had one for two weeks once. Wound down the car window one day and threw it as far as I could. Never been tempted again. If you insist on carrying one of these miserable things, have the good sense to turn it off. A lot. In my seminars, by the way, we assess a $100 fine anytime a cell phone erupts. And confiscate the offending phone for the duration.

THE PAY PHONE IN A BOOTH WITH A FOLDING DOOR ON IT WAS A WONDERFULLY CIVILIZED THING.

And a word to business owners and salespeople who devoutly believe they must be instantly accessible at any and every moment to every client and prospective client to prevent that client from dialing the next number and doing business with whomever answers instantly: If you are that interchangeable, that mundane and ordinary a commodity, you've got big, big problems, far bigger than you can solve by answering your cell



phone while you're on the can. Turn off the thing long enough to read my No B.S. Sales Success book.

THAT'S URGENT. YOUR TELEPHONE DEFENSE

If you buy into this tactic at all, you will obviously need a good screening system. What will protect you from the telephone? If you have a live person, a receptionist or secretary, or a receptionist plus a secretary, that's probably best. (If not, you'll have to use voice mail or an answering machine.)

Your receptionist or secretary needs a continually updated "VIP list" of people from whom you will almost always take an incoming call, regardless of what else you may be doing. This prevents you from missing calls you really want, and it allows your assistant to screen all the other calls with great confidence.

Keeping this VIP list up-to-date helps prevent screening faux pas. However, even when a faux pas occurs, you must never sacrifice your assistant to the cause. You must support the person doing your screening 100% of the time. Screeners can only do the job if they have complete confidence in what they're doing.

You have to decide on the severity of the screening to be done. In my case, on any given day, I'll get a few VIP calls and up to two dozen calls from other people of unknown priority, including prospective new clients, book reviewers, media contacts, and salespeople. If I were in my office for the whole day and took these calls as they occurred, and each one averaged only three minutes, I would have let loose of an hour. But much more importantly, I would have been interrupted 24 times!

The three minutes given each call would have cost me another ten minutes added on—the time required to get back in gear after each interruption; 13 minutes times 24 calls equals FIVE HOURS of lost time!

So I have a very tough-minded policy. First, all callers are asked their reason for calling. People refusing to provide good information about their reason for calling NEVER get a return call.

Second, prospective clients are asked to send information in writing—by mail or fax—so that I can look at it at my convenience and have the flexibility of responding as I judge best: calling, writing, sending information before calling, delegating, or referring elsewhere. If they won't do that, they NEVER get to me.

Salespeople are told pretty much the same thing. If they won't play by my rules, they NEVER get through. The "tone" is polite but firm. I tend to return calls only once or twice a week, more often than not via pre-arranged, back-to-back, time-limited phone appointments.

I know, you're mumbling about the 52 reasons you can't do such things in your business because your business is different and your clients or customers won't tolerate it. Pfui. It's not like I'm the president or the pope or J-Lo or anybody like that. I'm basically a self-glorified salesman. I've simply done the following three things anyone can do:

You may or may not want to be as tough as I am in this regard. You may not even want to be as tough as many of my clients who've adopted modified versions of my approach. But I will bet you the biggest steak in Texas that you can benefit from a tougher screening process than you have now. Think about it.

USE THE FAX

Next, we've got to gain control over, and productively use, the fax machine. I really love the fax machine. I think it's terrific. It's just about my favorite "appliance." And there are two really good ways to use this magic box to enhance your personal productivity. But, first, let's tackle the "dark side" of this thing....

People who send you faxes think that they've instantly communicated with you and that they should get an immediate response from you. Incredibly, they have this illusion that faxing a document is exactly the same as plunking it into your hands. I guess you're supposed to be sitting there, right next to the fax, watching and waiting.

This was, and occasionally still is, a big problem for me. On a typical day, there will be 20 to 50 "overnight faxes" waiting, and, during the day, another 20, 30, or more will come zipping in. And remember, I'm not there anyway. So, my beleaguered staff person takes care of the ones she can. The rest get separated into those she judges to be urgent, which get forwarded to me by fax, and those she believes can wait to go in with my week's mail.

Even when I was around, I refused to let people pressure me by faxing. I refused to have my day's plan disrupted by faxes. I refused to be controlled by someone else's priorities. So, we have to educate clients/customers about all this.

Everything I just said about faxes goes quadruple for e-mail. I haven't, and I won't, use e-mail any more than I'll use a cell phone. Listen up: you are not obligated to respond to inbound e-mail instantly, quickly, or ever. I don't need to tell you that if you don't stick a cork in this widening hole, you'll drown trying to handle e-mail. Get tough or die.

With each easier, faster means of

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communicating, the quantity of dumb, junk communication has multiplied. Because sending e-mail is so easy and doesn't even require the labor of walking over to the fax machine, people send e-mails any time they have a brain fart. In the corporate environment, the individual e-mails have become another Time Vampire trick—a less laborious equivalent of just popping in, standing in the doorway, saying "Got just a minute?"

Again, you may or may not want or need to mirror me. But if you're like many people, and you jump up every time a fax arrives for you, you can't possibly be productive. And if you're checking your e-mail constantly, compulsively, or worse, if you're responding to messages as they arrive—you're headed for an early grave.

For somebody in an office, I think a good system is to take some time after lunch to look at the morning's faxes, e-mails, and phone calls, deal ONLY with those that are genuinely urgent, and set the others aside. Then, during the last hour of the work day, look at the afternoon's accumulated incoming messages, quickly deal with those most urgent, and integrate all the rest into your next day's plans. For road warriors, a strategy more like mine may be appropriate.

For far too many people, the phone, the fax machine, e-mail, FedEx—heck, for some people, the mail—invokes a Pavlovian, jump-up-and-instantly-respond reaction. If it has never occurred to you before, you ought to look at this now as weird behavior.

WHO'S IN CHARGE ANYWAY?

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If you do take an incoming call, when you get on the phone with someone, it's a smart idea to set up the exit time first. For example, I may say: "Tom, I have a conference call starting in just 15 minutes, but I wanted to take your call. I hope that will be enough time for our discussion. Do you agree, or should we set up another telephone appointment?"

TICK, TICK, TICK.

When someone "drops in," and you decide to go ahead and see him, when you bring him into your office, it's a smart idea to set up the exit time first: "Bob, it's difficult these days for me to see drop-in visitors, but it's good to see you. We'll only have half an hour, though, but no longer, as I have an important conference call set for 4 o'clock. That's OK, isn't it?"

TICK, TICK, TICK.

You won't win any awards for being sociable, but you'll have shorter, more purposeful telephone conversations and meetings. Drop-ins will gradually get the message. Callers will gradually learn to call ahead and set up a phone appointment, or at least, to prepare and be efficient when calling.

I call this "setting the timer on the bomb." I even have a clock that looks just like six sticks of dynamite wired together, with a timer on it, and the timer has a flashing red light. This gets a lot of attention plunked down in the center of the conference table. If you're not going to do this physically, you at least want to do it verbally.

You see, most people will suck up about as much time as you let them. Salespeople calling on you feel productive and satisfied as long as they're talking with customers, and will even extend conversations with a friendly customer as a means of avoiding the risk of confronting new prospects. Employees, too, will dawdle in conversation; it beats working!

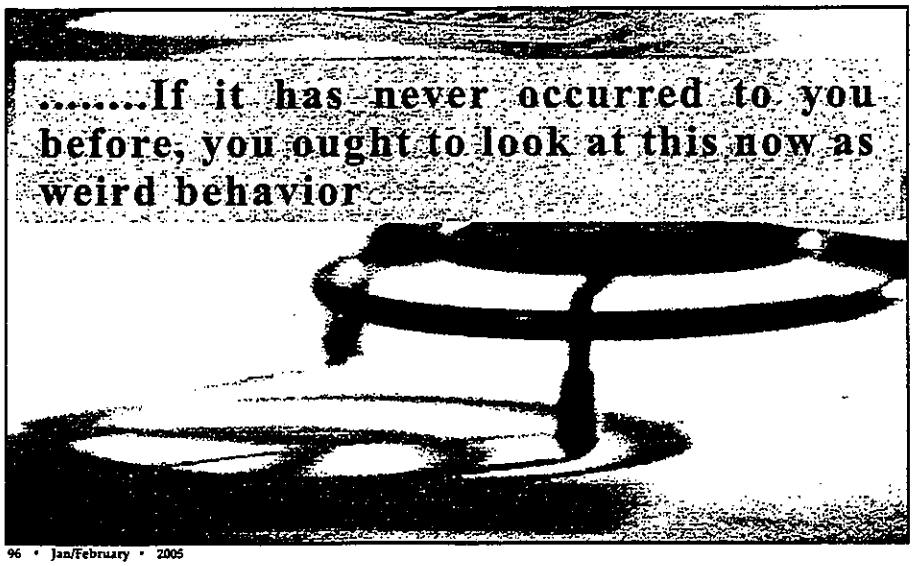
Conversations have a way of stretching to fill whatever amount of time is available for them.

IT'S NOT ENOUGH TO BE BUSY—AND BE SEEN BEING BUSY

Obviously, busy people are interrupted less than unbusy people. Just as burglars pass up some homes in favor of others, looking for the easiest, safest targets, those who steal and suck up time by interrupting others tend to cruise the office looking for the best opportunity and the easiest target.

If you are sitting at your desk, comfortably, appearing relaxed, you're it. Of course, you might be contemplating a formula for disarming a nuclear warhead, but that won't matter, because it's not obvious.

WHEN YOU ARE VISIBLE TO OTHERS, IT'S BEST TO BE VISIBLY BUSY.



This article is an edited excerpt from Dan Kennedy's irreverent and provocative new book—the revised, expanded and updated 2nd Edition of *No B.S. Time Management for Entrepreneurs: The Ultimate, No Holds Barred, Kick Butt, Take No Prisoners Guide to Time, Productivity & Sanity*. Just published by Entrepreneur Press, it's available in bookstores and via major online booksellers. For more information, visit the author's website: nobsbooks.com

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Where Did My New Years' Resolution Go?
9 Strategies To Rescue Those Resolutions!

By Dan S. Kennedy

Resolve comes easily on December 31st.

By March of the new year, the resolutions made are in disarray, compromised, abandoned. And the resolute determination to make this year, finally, the year you stick to 'em, forgotten altogether.

This is not about guilt over this abandonment. Instead, it is about the real reasons resolutions and the determination to achieve them are lost, year after year after year, and how to change – yet this year – and get on track to systematically set and achieve new goals.

Big Idea #1: you can't achieve new goals or make desired changes without allocating time to do so. Check out page 63 of my NO B.S. TIME MANAGEMENT FOR ENTREPRENEURS BOOK* for 'time-blocking' strategy instructions. A big reason that resolutions never become reality is no room made for them in the daily schedule! If your days are already full, and you resolve to get in a 1/2 hour a day on the treadmill or on your laptop, writing that book, that 1/2 hour has to come from somewhere. Something's gotta give! You have to find something or things currently consuming time you can cut 5 or 10 or 15 minutes from.

Big Idea #2: priorities should govern schedule, schedule shouldn't govern priorities. On pages 69-74 and 103-111 of the same book, I talk about the mistake made by the vast majority of business owners and entrepreneurs – they operate like workers instead of bosses and leaders. They report to a workplace, then they let people and events ad interruptions come at them all day, take control of their day. You have to wrest control away from others' priorities and govern by your priorities. President Bush cited Social Security reform and tax reform as top priorities of his second term, presumably accompanied by resolution of the mess in Iraq. Then along came the tusunami. Still, he organized his tax reform panel. It's hard to judge from outside looking in, but my belief about W. is that he's determined to govern by his priorities. Are you?

Big Idea #3: resolutions aren't resolutions without resolve. Only you can decide what really matters to you. You shouldn't bother with 'lip service' faux resolutions, made to appease or satisfy others. Honesty with self is a pre-requisite for success.

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Big Idea #4: resolutions require resources. Almost anything you decide to do, any change you decide to make, any goal you set out to achieve requires new or different resources. That might be a piece of home exercise equipment or different food in the cupboard, a private work environment outside the office, information, people. You aren't really serious about a resolution unless you invest in and gather the required resources. Sometimes investment motivates follow-through, too.

Big Idea #5: daily progress. Take the objective and break it all the way down to a timeline and to-do list for each day, from now to fruition. In talking about how he built 'The Sharper Image' from a college kid's coffee table start-up to nearly a billion dollar business, Richard Thalleimer references the Bill Murray movie, 'What About Bob?, with the psychologist who advocates "Baby Steps." Thallheimer says he still approaches every new project that way today. Good enough for a guy running a billion dollar company, good enough for you. Nothing gets done in occasional big leaps. I wrote four books last year, one hour a day, a handful of pages each day. Here's the goal and discipline that is guaranteed certain to move you closer to any goal each and every day: refuse to end any day without doing some thing, no matter how small, that moves you toward the goal! "The One Thing Behavioral Rule" makes a huge difference.

Big Idea #6: who motivates the motivator? Paul Meyer, founder of Success Motivation Institute, posed this provocative question. As an entrepreneur, as the leader, you may be doing a lot of motivating of others, but who motivates you? For the most part, you need to create self-motivation with structure, like Big Idea#5. But you can also get into a coaching group, tele-coaching program, hire a one-on-one coach, or just pair up with a like-minded buddy, so there's somebody to hold you accountable, to report progress to, to get an atta-boy! from. Any professional sports coach will tell you: measurement automatically improves performance, and measurement monitored by someone else further improves performance.

Big Idea #7: Build up to change. I've neglected the treadmill for six months, now I'm going back to it. Began January 1st. I'm writing this on the 8th and I'm still 100%. The goal is 30 minutes a day, but if I try doing that out of the starting gate, I'm a goner. So I've started with a measly 5 minutes a day first half of January, 10 minutes a day for next 15 days, 15 minutes a day for all of February – and I'll miss 10 days while traveling, then 20 minutes a day in March, up to 30 minutes by April. This addresses the tricky balancing act, a desireable and motivating goal but also an achievable goal. So, say you resolve to get up an hour earlier every morning to work on some project. You could start with 15 minutes for two weeks, then 20 minutes for two weeks, then 30 for a month, then 45 for two weeks.

Big Idea #8: It's not too late to re-group! You may already have let your resolutions slip away. Doesn't matter. Today, tonight, tomorrow morning at the latest, block out a couple hours, bolt the door, unplug phone, and re-group. Review the resolutions. Pick one or two or three that mean the most, and apply the above seven ideas.

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Big Idea #9: Make better use of your time. Resolve weakens under pressure, under stress, when you feel your time is out of your control. That's the set of circumstances that allows procrastination to gain a foothold. If you want to be more resolute about keeping your resolutions, you must become unwaveringly resolute about controlling your time. A lot of what's in my NO B.S. TIME MANAGEMENT FOR ENTREPRENEURS BOOK has to do with training or re-training all the people in your world to respect your time, to co-operate and facilitate your peak productivity.

About The Author: Dan Kennedy is the author of nine business books, including his newest, NO B.S. TIME MANAGEMENT FOR ENTREPRENEURS, available in bookstores or from online booksellers. Additional information and free chapter previews at www.nobsbooks.com. Included with the book, a coupon for a free kit of peak personal productivity tools. Kennedy is also a busy entrepreneur, consultant, speaker and direct-response advertising copywriter. Info at www.dankennedy.com.

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Are You More Or Less Effective Than You Were A Year Ago? You Have More Technology. You 'Process' More Work. But Are You More Effective?

By Dan S. Kennedy

There is a 'secret key' to peak personal productivity and performance that entrepreneurs are unwittingly depriving themselves of, to a worsening extent from one year to the next. This subtle form of self-sabotage takes its toll many different ways.

Entrepreneurs and sales professionals need 'resiliency.' We face opposition, we experience rejection and disappointment, we resolve problems in greater quantity and intensity than people in jobs, who work for others only 9 to 5. Our need to quickly and frequently rebound is far greater than for most people.

Consequently, we need to engineer into our daily schedules a sufficient amount of recovery time.

Most businesspeople have given it all away and have none.

What is 'recovery time'? It is quiet time. Time to think. Time to re-gain perspective. Time for casual, stress-relieving conversation about other things than business. Such recovery time used to exist naturally and automatically in everyday life. While walking from the office to a restaurant for lunch. Driving in the car. Waiting in an airport. But all this is gone, given up to cellphone glued to ear, checking e-mail ten times a day. The result of all this is NOT improved productivity. Not at all. Oh, there's a greater QUANTITY of communication taking place, that's obvious. But as the QUANTITY has multiplied, the QUALITY has suffered. Today's entrepreneur or sales pro is immersed in all this communication under greater stress and tension, which diminishes attention span, listening skill, comprehension, clear thought, breeds rushed, ill-considered response, short(er) tempers.

Peter Drucker, the godfather of industrial productivity and quality, makes a huge point about the **distinction between *'efficiency'* and *'effectiveness.'*** Too many people are sacrificing 'effectiveness'.

Being instantly or constantly accessible to your clients or employees does *not* necessarily mean you are more effective in those sales, service or managerial roles. In fact, it's a very good bet, you are less effective. Returning phone calls and engaging in conversation while also speed-walking through an airport, dodging passer-by, in a din of noise (vs. waiting and returning calls in a hotel room with quiet and privacy) does *not* make you more effective. No, again, less effective.

No one can perform at optimum effectiveness – thinking, appraising, formulating ideas, communicating, persuading, negotiating or managing – if under unrelenting pressure.

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Few people can communicate with optimum effectiveness under extremely adverse environmental conditions.

In my book NO B.S. TIME MANAGEMENT FOR ENTREPRENEURS, I lay out a compelling case for taking new, stronger control over both technology and time, and re-organizing your management of both, to heighten your effectiveness and to enhance your resiliency.

If you want to be more effective this year than last, you'll focus on quality, not just quantity, and you'll exert new control over your time, relationships and communication.

About The Author: Dan Kennedy is the author of nine business books, including his newest, NO B.S. TIME MANAGEMENT FOR ENTREPRENEURS, available in bookstores or from online booksellers. Additional information and free chapter previews at www.nobsbooks.com. Included with the book, a coupon for a free kit of peak personal productivity tools. Kennedy is also a busy entrepreneur, consultant, speaker and direct-response advertising copywriter. Info at www.dankennedy.com.

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When Less Is More

By Dan S. Kennedy

Entrepreneurs, by nature, instinct, conditioning, competitive spirit are very into "more". So are sales professionals. More gross revenues. *More* sales. *More* customers or clients. *More* web site traffic. *More* leads. Even more square footage, more employees. **But more is not necessarily better, not necessarily more profitable or even proportionately profitable**. The unbridled lust for growth of any kind at any cost gets a lot of business owners into a lot of trouble. For salespeople, it can lead to burn-out. For both, their best clientele being poorly served and neglected as quality thins to accommodate quantity.

Few business owners take the time and trouble to carefully and analytically study their present customers or clients, account by account, for contribution to net profit. Few entrepreneurs analyze their own activities and time useage the same way, in terms of contribution to net profit. When they do, they discover the classic 80/20, 20/80 Rule is alive and well, and further, that there's a 95/5, 5/95 Rule too. In brief, 80% of profits tend to come from 20% of clients and time. Usually about 5% of clients and 5% of time use prove infinitely more valuable than the other 95%. The results of this rarely done analysis are often: getting rid of the least profitable clients, stopping or delegating or otherwise altering the least profitable time use. In many instances where I've come in as consultant to a business, coach to an entrepreneur, I've made less into more, by pruning away the clientele consuming 80% of the resources but contributing only 20% of the profits, creating fewer customers rather than more, and enhancing the relationships with the 20% who contribute 80% of the profits. Most business owners are being supported by a relatively small, often shockingly small number of "best" customers; all the rest, the bigger number are illusion. **Most entrepreneurs are also producing 95% of their income and wealth from only 5% of their time. Even a slight re-adjustment in time investment can multiply income.**

In my NO B.S. TIME MANAGEMENT BOOK FOR ENTREPRENEURS, we begin in Chapter 1 with some math exercises, to accurately determine what your time is worth, what it must be worth to achieve your goals. Together, we shift your thinking about time to investing, to allocating, managing and measuring results in terms of investment and return on investment. The business operation changes and behavioral changes this provokes are frequently radical, dramatic, exciting and extremely beneficial. I promise, you'll do some very serious thinking about the ways you invest your time if you read that Chapter.

The big questions are these – do you actually know what your hour must be worth, in order to reach your desired income goal for the year? Do you accept and prioritize responsibilities, projects, opportunities, reject, delegate away, based on that number? Do you have good 'future banking' statistics so you can judge the value of what you just did with the last hour? **In short, are you doing your best to consciously, deliberate,**

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mathematically, financially hold yourself accountable for the ways you invest your time?

I hate the near extinction of full serve gas stations. In the ten minutes required to pump gas and wipe windshield and windows myself, I could have sat comfortably in the car and listened to an informative tape, jotted an answer to a memo, read an item from a newsletter or magazine or just thought about a business matter – any one of which infinitely more valuable than the minimum wage job of pumping gas. It is example of the fact that we let ourselves do low wage work much too frequently. You wouldn't take it as a part-time job and go pump gas or clean your house or mow your grass for $8.00 an hour, would you?

If you mow your lawn as recreation, as exercise, as a hobby that you genuinely enjoy, that's one thing. But if you do it because you're too cheap to find and pay a kid to do it, that's another.

Add to this the "more problem", the piling on of "more" that produces on more low wage work and low value consumption of time for you. This you must be very, very careful of. The more successful you become, the more your entire approach to opportunity and to time must evolve.

Consider something as simple as the client who requires an excessive amount of time, access, coddling. As your time and your staff's time grows more valuable, he becomes less valuable. If, to reach your goals, your hour must be worth $1,000.00 and your staff's $100.00, and he consumes 10 hours a year of each more than the next client, he costs you an extra $11,000.00. But if your time has to be worth $2,000.00, your staff's $200.00, the same 10 hours of your time plus 10 hours of staff time leaps to $22,000.00. If his contribution to income stays the same, he's instantly worth $11,000.00 less. At what point does he cost more than he's worth? At what point are you better off without his revenue altogether? Your gross might dip, but your net might improve. And/or that vacuum fill with a more profitable account.

The all-time champion worst idea for doubling your income is to double your work.

You'll be a rich corpse.

This is also the most unimaginative, uncreative, non-analytical approach. Consider farmers. At one time they all plowed with mules. They tried to get the mules to pull harder, move faster. They hitched two, three or four mules together. Then tractors. Then faster tractors. All the same brute force multiplied. One of my earliest consulting clients in the 1970's was a company that did very complex, detailed soil analysis of farms. Their sales rep collected soil samples in test tubes from every part of the farm. In the lab, they analyzed each sample. On a color-coded map, they depicted nutrient and mineral deficiencies --- different in soil only a few feet away from another hunk of ground. They prescribed different fertilizers for different parts of the farm. The soil's ability to produce was greatly multiplied. Not by the farmer working longer hours, not by more mules

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pulling harder, not by a bigger tractor. By scientifically, strategically, cleverly leveraging the real asset: the soil.

Now consider salespeople. To increase income, they will try to generate more leads, squeeze in more presentations, run more appointments, work longer hours, talk on the cellphone while driving, eating, even while peeing! But that's not leveraging the real assets: time and sales skill.

Consider the business owner. Same approach. More advertising, more leads, more customers, more products, longer hours.

It is all too common to attempt reaching bigger financial goals simplistically, by adding more customers to beget more sales even if you must personally work more hours and juggle more responsibility and absorb more stress, and add more overhead. But this IS simplistic. Almost unthinking. Certainly uncreative. A more creative, cerebral, interesting approach is to search for ways to achieve more with less.

About The Author: Dan Kennedy is the author of nine business books, including his newest, NO B.S. TIME MANAGEMENT FOR ENTREPRENEURS, available in bookstores or from online booksellers. Additional information and free chapter previews at www.nobsbooks.com. Included with the book, a coupon for a free kit of peak personal productivity tools. Kennedy is also a busy entrepreneur, consultant, speaker and direct-response advertising copywriter. Info at www.dankennedy.com.

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Wise Stewardship Of Your Life Energy

by Lee Milteer

It seems that fatigue is ever-increasing, a more frequent experience and challenge. You start the week on Monday morning enthused, invigorated, optimistic, motivated to follow-through on goals, plans, to-do lists. But as the days progress, all that positive energy dissipates. Where does the energy go?

We are made of energy – mentally, physically, emotionally, spiritually. The choices you make about spending your life energy have outcomes. Your life is financed by the resources you have available to you. You must be conscious of how you spend the energy you have. If you indiscriminately spend your life energy, you may burn out, you may be too tired to capitalize on the best opportunities as they come along.

Entrepreneurs and salespeople need to preserve time and energy for themselves. You need quality time to make quality decisions. Quality time to create, think, invent and plan, to develop sales, marketing and profit breakthroughs. Quality time to network and build relationships. Time is needed to collect and assimilate information. For education and self-renewal, rest, rejuvenation. Hobbies and fun. Family. These things cannot survive on your left-over time and energy!

Taking control of your time and more carefully spending your energy can be the single biggest step toward extraordinary success you will ever take.

How Much Do You Value Your Time And Energy?

As Dan Kennedy says in his NO B.S. TIME MANAGEMENT FOR ENTREPRENEURS book: "if you don't know what your time is worth, you can't expect the world to know either."

The use or misuse or abuse by others of your time is the single most important factor affecting your life energy. One of the clients I've worked with a lot, on personal performance, is NASA – but it doesn't take a rocket scientist to figure out that the time and energy you permit others to take is then unavailable to you.

The question to keep front and center is: ***how can I best use my resources of time and energy to manifest what I want?***

Most people let time and energy get away, let other people and circumstances control them. Dan's NO B.S. TIME book is about doing the opposite. You exercise control to manifest your desires by creating boundaries and having a personal time plan that you live by. Focus on developing and sticking with habits that support your plan.

The Power Of Quiet, Personal Time

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"All man's miseries derive from not being able to sit quietly in a room alone," the famous scientist Blaise Pascal observed. In our noisy world, we are bombarded by sound, by loud music, sirens, construction, others' conversations. When we enter a room, we habitually turn on the television, radio, computer. Many people preserve no quiet time whatsoever in each day, even each week.

Spiritual teachers tend to agree that we need to go into silence for wisdom. When you can visit the silent spaces of your mind and turn off the external noise, you are most likely to discover new possibilities and opportunities, new and different solutions to nagging problems. Quiet time can recharge your life energy. I urge you to demand more silence in your life. I urge you to create, to schedule quiet times.

Are you a human *being* – or a human *doing*? Our lives have become endless work, non-stop activity. This kind of non-stop 'doing' wears you down and wears you out. I advise my coaching clients to radically change their schedules and set aside one out of every seven days when they do not answer the phone, they do not do business, they make up a day of relaxation, recreation, quiet time, and time with family. This is not a new idea. There is the tradition of the Sabbath, one day a week set aside as holy, for rest, rehabilitation, prayer, meditation, thought and family, not work. This has been lost to many today. People who used to rest on Saturday or Sunday now spend those days shopping, working around the house, paying bills and conducting business. Don't you think you deserve one day of real rest each week?

One of my coaching clients, Kelly, said that when he went back to the old-fashioned tradition of taking Sundays off, he saw immediate improvement in his clarity, enthusiasm, energy and ability to be of service to his clients. Kelly is a real estate agent and it was unheard of in his company not to work on Sundays. His boss told him he'd never make a living not working weekends. Kelly started explaining to his clients that he wanted to give them the best possible service, and preserving Sundays for his family and God helped him do that. He attracted clients who respected his beliefs. He soon started his own company, and now includes the fact that Sundays are preserved for family life in his advertising. His agents are grateful for the day with their families. His company is one of the top brokerages in his city. In his TIME book, Dan insists that you can train your clients to respect your time and to do business on your terms, I wholeheartedly agree, and the experiences of my coaching clients like Kelly prove it to be true.

Any time is a good time to reconsider your personal time plan! Remember, the question to keep front and center is: *how can I best use my resources of time and energy to manifest what I want?*

About The Author: Lee Milteer is an author, speaker and performance coach to entrepreneurs, business owners and executives. Her corporate clients have included top companies like FedEx and Disney. Her tele-coaching programs are subscribed to by thousands of business owners, and provided to thousands of business owners by their marketing advisors. This article was drawn from her forthcoming, new book *Spiritual Power Tools For Successful Selling.* Her other book is *Success Is An Inside Job.* Information is at www.milteer.com. Dan Kennedy's book mentioned in this article, NO

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